

CITY: Pg 3

Oppn anti-women: CM Rekha Gupta



NATION: Pg 5

This Assembly election is to save Bengal's identity, says PM Modi



FILM: Pg 16

Deepika & Ranveer announce second pregnancy



IRAN HAS NOT CONFIRMED TALKS

Trump sends Vance-led team for talks with Iran, repeats threat to Iran's infra

ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump said US negotiators will head to Pakistan on Monday for another round of talks with Iran, raising hopes of extending a fragile ceasefire set to expire by Wednesday even as Washington and Tehran remain in a standoff over the Strait of Hormuz.

Iran did not immediately confirm the talks but its chief negotiator, parliament speaker Mohammed Bagher Qalibaf, said in an interview aired on state television late Saturday that "there will be no retreat in the field of diplomacy" while acknowledging a wide gap remained between the sides.

The White House said Vice President JD Vance, who led the first round of historic face-to-face talks last weekend, would lead the delegation to Pakistan with envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner.

Pakistani authorities began tightening security in Islamabad. A regional official involved in the efforts said mediators were finalising preparations and US advance security teams were already on the ground.

Iran on Saturday said it had received new proposals from the US. It was unclear whether either side

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Tankers and gas carriers anchored in the Strait of Hormuz, Saturday

PTI

KEY POINTS

- » Qalibaf says diplomacy continues despite wide gaps
- » White House: JD Vance to lead delegation with envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner
- » Pakistan tightens Islamabad security; mediators prepare; US advance teams already deployed.
- » Iran received new US proposals; unclear if positions shifted on key disputes.
- » Major sticking points include nuclear enrichment, regional proxies, and Strait of Hormuz control.
- » Strait remains disrupted; US blockade and Iranian threats halt ship transit

Indian tanker clears Hormuz as two vessels turn back after firing

NEW DELHI: An Indian-flagged crude tanker completed its passage through the Strait of Hormuz even as heightened tensions in the region forced several other vessels to turn back following reports of gunfire, prompting India to take up the issue with Iran.

The tanker Desh Garima, carrying 31 Indian crew members, crossed the strategic

waterway on April 18 and is scheduled to arrive in Mumbai on April 22, according to a government update. It is the tenth India-flagged vessel to successfully transit the strait since early March.

However, the situation remained volatile. Very large crude carrier Samnar Herad and bulk carrier Jag Arnav reported a firing incident within the past 24 hours

while navigating the passage and subsequently returned to the Persian Gulf. No injuries were reported among crew members.

Shipping data indicated that two other Indian-flagged tankers, Desh Vaibhav and Desh Vibhor, also reversed course near the chokepoint, taking the number of such vessels currently in the Persian Gulf to 14.

In response, India's foreign secretary summoned Iran's ambassador in New Delhi to convey "deep concern" over the incident. He stressed the need to ensure the safety of merchant shipping and urged Tehran to facilitate the movement of India-bound vessels. "India attaches importance to the safety of merchant shipping and mariners," the government said

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TAMIL NADU

At least 23 killed in explosion at Virudhunagar firecracker unit

MPOST BUREAU

VIRUDHUNAGAR (TAMIL NADU): At least 23 people were killed and six others suffered severe injuries after a powerful explosion tore through a private firecracker manufacturing unit in Tamil Nadu's Virudhunagar district on Sunday, officials said.

The incident occurred at the 'Vanaja' fireworks factory in Kattannarpatti, which falls under the Vachakarapatti police station limits. The unit is owned by Muthumanickam. According to preliminary findings, the facility reportedly holds a licence issued by the Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation in Nagpur. More than 100 workers were said to be present at the complex at the time of the explosion.

Investigators believe the blast originated in the front veranda area of the factory, where workers were han-



Firefighters at the site of blast

PTI

KEY POINTS

- » Blast occurred at 'Vanaja' fireworks unit in Kattannarpatti under Vachakarapatti police limits
- » Factory owned by Muthumanickam; held PESO licence, preliminary probe indicates
- » Over 100 labourers reportedly present at the time of the explosion
- » Explosion believed to have originated in front veranda during handling of raw materials

dling raw materials and were engaged in the final stages of cracker production. The explosion

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SRINAGAR AIRPORT

Two US nationals held with satellite phone

SRINAGAR: Two US nationals were detained at the Srinagar International Airport on Sunday after a satellite phone was recovered from their luggage during routine screening,

officials said. The two have been detained for questioning, the officials said.

Further details awaited as the probe continues.

The use of any kind of satellite phone in India is

allowed only with prior licence from the Department of Telecommunications. Anyone coming to India with a satellite phone in their baggage must declare it on arrival.

AGENCIES

Dinesh Trivedi to be next High Commissioner to Bangladesh



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Former Union minister Dinesh Trivedi has been appointed India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh. The former MP from West Bengal's Barrackpore had joined the BJP in 2021 after leaving the Trinamool Congress. He has served as Railway Minister and Union Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare.

He is the first political appointee in the neighbouring country where a newly elected government, headed by Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) recently assumed office under the prime ministership of Tarique Rahman. Trivedi will replace

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India, US chief negotiators to begin three-day trade pact talks today

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: About a dozen Indian officials are set to reach Washington on April 20 for a fresh round of negotiations with US counterparts on the first phase of the proposed bilateral trade agreement, according to an official familiar with the matter. The three-day discussions, scheduled from April 20 to April 22, come amid shifts in the US tariff regime that may require both sides to revisit the existing framework of the pact.

India's delegation will be led by chief negotiator Darpan Jain, an additional secretary in the commerce department. Officials from the customs department and the ministry of external affairs will also participate in the talks. "The meeting will happen from April 20-22 in Washington DC," the official said.

The negotiations follow significant policy changes in the United States. After the US Supreme Court struck

The negotiations follow significant policy changes in the United States

down sweeping reciprocal tariffs introduced earlier by President Donald Trump under the 1977 International Emergency Economic Powers Act, the administration imposed a uniform 10 per cent tariff on all countries for 150 days starting February 24. These developments prompted a postponement of an earlier meeting between the two sides that had been scheduled for February.

Given the altered tariff environment, both countries are expected to reassess the terms of the agreement, the framework of which was released on February 7. "So the agreement will have to be recalibrated, redrafted," a government source said, noting that the changes would largely stem from the US side. "In our case,

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LPG consumption slides 13% amid West Asia crisis

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India's consumption of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) declined sharply in March, falling by nearly 13 per cent year-on-year as supply chains were strained by the ongoing conflict in West Asia, according to official data.

Total LPG usage stood at 2.379 million tonnes during the month, compared with 2.729 million tonnes in March last year, marking a 12.8 per cent drop. The decline comes as disruptions in key import routes affected availability for both domestic and commercial consumers.

India relies on imports for about 60 per cent of its LPG needs, with a significant portion transported through the Strait of Hormuz. That route faced severe interruptions following military actions involving the United States, Israel, and Iran. Supplies from major exporters such as Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates were also affected.

In response, the government reduced

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No highway parking for heavy vehicles, SC issues pan-India safety directions

Says expressways should not become corridor of peril

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a significant intervention on road safety, the Supreme Court has issued a comprehensive set of directions aimed at reducing accidents on national highways and expressways across India, warning that such roads must not become "corridors of peril" due to administrative inaction or infrastructure shortcomings.

A bench comprising Justices JK Maheshwari and AS Chandurkar underlined the disproportionate share of fatalities occurring on national highways, noting that while they make up only about two per cent of the country's total road network, they account for nearly 30 per cent of road deaths. The court

HIGHLIGHTS

- » No highway parking for heavy vehicles except designated bays
- » ATMS-based enforcement with GPS evidence and e-challans
- » 60-day compliance deadline for all authorities
- » SOPs for inspections and highway patrolling
- » Ban on new roadside dhabas within highway ROW

described this imbalance as a matter of urgent concern requiring coordinated action from multiple authorities.

The directions were issued to the Ministry of Road Trans-

- » Remove unauthorised structures within 60 days
- » Mandatory NHAI/PWD clearance for licences in safety zones
- » Review existing licences within 30 days
- » District highway safety task forces within 15 days
- » Multi-agency coordination via task forces
- » Increased surveillance and anti-illegal parking drives

port and Highways, the National Highways Authority of India, and all States and Union Territories. The court said that preventable hazards such as illegal parking and accident-prone

- » Cameras, speed detectors, emergency systems rollout
- » Identify and fix accident blackspots
- » Build truck lay-bys and wayside amenities
- » Improve highway lighting
- » MoRTH to submit compliance report in 75 days
- » Liberty to approach court on compliance issues
- » Supreme Court review in two months

stretches reflect systemic lapses. "The loss of even a single life to avoidable hazards like illegal parking or blackspots represents a failure of the State's protective umbrella,"

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POLICE STEP UP CRACKDOWN

Delhi logs 269 drunk driving cases in three-hour night op

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Traffic Police has booked 269 people for drunk driving during a special integrated night checking across the national capital, officials said on Sunday.

The three-hour operation was conducted between 9 pm and midnight on Saturday in coordination with local police and PCR units as part of an ongoing campaign against driving under the influence of alcohol.

Police said 269 offenders were caught for drunk driving during the drive, with 38 vehicles impounded for serious breaches.

"All categories of vehicles, including two-wheelers, cars, heavy transport vehicles, light goods vehicles and autorickshaws, were checked during the drive," a senior traffic police officer said.

The drive was conducted simultaneously across all traffic ranges in the city, with teams deployed at key junctions and vulnerable stretches to identify the violators.

The initiative was part of a sustained effort to curb road accidents caused by



TAKEAWAYS

» 269 offenders were caught for drunk driving during the drive, with 38 vehicles impounded

» All categories of vehicles, including two-wheelers, cars, heavy transport vehicles, light goods vehicles and autorickshaws, were checked during the drive,' a senior traffic police officer said

drunk driving, which remains a major concern in the capital, police said.

According to Delhi Traffic Police data, 7,478 drivers have been prosecuted for drunk driving from January 1 to date. Of these, 6,844 cases resulted in prosecution, and 634 vehicles were impounded.

Two-wheeler riders accounted for the majority of the violations, with 4,906 cases recorded so far this year, followed by car drivers with 908 cases.

"Strict enforcement drives will continue in the coming days, especially during late-night hours and weekends, when instances of drunk driving tend to rise. People are advised not to drink and drive," the officer said.

Row erupts at Gargi College as breach during DUSU-linked entry sparks safety concerns, re-poll demands

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Tensions flared at University of Delhi's Gargi College during ongoing student council elections, as allegations of forcible entry, intimidation, and disruption triggered demands for an independent inquiry and re-election. The incident has reignited concerns around campus safety, particularly in women's institutions, and the integrity of student-led democratic processes.

According to multiple female students, a group of individuals allegedly linked to the Delhi University Students' Union entered the college premises following a reported breach at the main gate. Eye-witnesses and circulating video footage suggest that the entry led to chaos within the campus.



Several students were also heard raising slogans against Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad, reflecting heightened tensions and opposition during the confrontation. Prompting strong resistance from students who demanded the immediate exit of the intruders. The situation reportedly caused distress among students and staff, raising serious questions about security preparedness.

Student organisations, including Akhil Bharatiya

Vidyarthi Parishad and Students' Federation of India, have traded accusations over the incident. While ABVP has alleged that rival groups attempted to disrupt the electoral process, Left-backed groups have countered with claims of intimidation and misconduct. A presidential candidate has also alleged mistreatment, intensifying calls for a re-election to ensure fairness and transparency.

The controversy has drawn

A women's college, by its very nature, is expected to provide a secure & protected environment

political attention also with leaders from the Aam Aadmi Party urging intervention. In a formal communication addressed to Lieutenant Governor, against DUSU president Aryan Mann and ABVP, concerns were raised regarding the alleged forcible entry by individuals, including those associated with student leadership, and the absence of immediate police action. The letter called for the registration of a First Information Report (FIR) and

a time-bound investigation. Beyond political contestation, the incident underscores deeper systemic concerns. A women's college, by its very nature, is expected to provide a secure and protected environment. Any breach not only disrupts academic functioning but also erodes the sense of safety essential for learning spaces.

As demands grow for accountability, key questions remain unresolved: how was campus access compromised, who bears responsibility for the lapse, and what institutional safeguards will be reinforced to prevent recurrence. For many students, the incident is not merely an electoral dispute but a test of whether safety and democratic norms can be upheld simultaneously within university spaces.

Police bust two illegal LPG rackets, 3 nabbed

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police busted two illegal LPG hoarding and refilling rackets in the city, seizing 125 cylinders and arresting three delivery agents, an official said on Sunday.

According to police, they recovered 57 cylinders, including 50 filled ones, along with a pickup vehicle, a weighing scale and equipment used for ille-

gal gas transfer from Rohini's Rama Vihar area.

"A man, identified as Lokpal (55), was arrested at the spot," a police officer said.

In another operation in Delhi's Sangam Vihar, 68 gas cylinders -- 36 filled, 29 empty and three with broken seals -- were seized, police said.

Two accused, identified as

Deepak (37) and Shyam (45), were arrested, they added.

Police said all three accused were authorised LPG delivery personnel who diverted cylinders instead of completing deliveries. They stockpiled them illegally and extracted small quantities of gas to refill empty cylinders using unauthorised equipment.

"They created artificial shortages by withholding supply and sold refilled cylinders in the open market at higher rates to earn undue profits," a senior officer said.

The accused siphoned 1-2 kg LPG into empty cylinders using motors and manual methods, selling at higher prices.

Delhi Golf Links heist: Six accused still on the run, fled in SUV with fake number plate

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The six accused in the Rs 25-lakh hostage-cum-robbery heist in the city's upscale Golf Links here remain at large, with police suspecting they may have fled the city after carrying out a planned robbery with the help of a domestic worker.

The accused are believed to have escaped in a light grey SUV fitted with a fake number plate, parked a short distance from the house, police sources said.

According to the sources, the gang had carried out a detailed recon before the robbery and identified gaps in surveillance in the upscale locality.

"They were aware that the lane leading to the house



Accused barged in with the help of the domestic worker, held the family hostage and ransacked the premises before fleeing with jewellery worth around Rs 25L

was not properly covered by CCTV cameras and that even the entrance lacked proper surveillance," a police source said.

The robbery occurred on Thursday evening when liquor businessman Ashok Chawla, his wife, daughter-in-law and her son were present inside the house. "The accused allegedly barged in with the help of the domestic worker, identified as Sushil, held the family hostage and ransacked the premises before fleeing with jewellery

worth around Rs 25 lakh," the source said.

The police informed that the gang had six members, including the key accused, Sushil, who joined the household barely a week before the incident and facilitated the entry of the other accused.

According to the police, Sushil was familiar with the layout of the house, including two entry and exit points.

"While the family did not permit anyone to use the

back door, he allegedly used his knowledge of it to help the gang escape from the back after entering through the main gate," a police officer said.

Police sources further noted that the other five accused had gathered in the vicinity nearly half an hour before the crime and arrived in smaller groups to avoid raising suspicion. After the robbery, all six fled together in the SUV. Police suspect insider role in robbery, probe former domestic workers' links. Accused Sushil allegedly took the victim's phone to avoid identification. CCTV suggests pre-planned entry. Family members were man-handled. Raids underway in Bihar and Uttar Pradesh, with security tightened and visitor checks intensified.

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police have arrested a man in connection with a firing incident at a CNG pump in Narela on Saturday.

Police said they received information about the incident through a PCR call at Narela Police Station. The gunshot was reported at a CNG pump in Sector A-7, near Satyawadi Raja Harischandra Hospital.

The accused has been identified as Vinit Kumar alias Binny (31), a resident of Ramdev Wali Gali in Pana Mamurpur, Narela.

Based on a complaint filed by Gopal, an FIR was registered under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the Arms Act.



Acting swiftly, police constituted a dedicated team to trace the accused. Using CCTV footage, technical surveillance and local intelligence, officers identified and apprehended him in a targeted operation.

During interrogation, Vinit confessed to the crime, stating that he had an altercation with staff at the CNG pump the previous night. Seeking revenge, he procured a country-made

Using CCTV footage, technical surveillance and local intelligence, officers identified and apprehended him

pistol and returned to the site, where he opened fire.

Police recovered a desi katta, one live cartridge, one spent cartridge, a bullet fragment, and the motorcycle used by the accused to flee.

Officials said the accused is in custody, and further investigation is underway to trace the source of the illegal weapon and examine any possible wider links in the case.

6 juveniles apprehended for stabbing teen to death in Samaypur Badli

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Six juveniles have been apprehended for allegedly murdering a 19-year-old man in outernorth Delhi's Samaypur Badli area, police said on Sunday.

The police apprehended the accused on Saturday after analysing CCTV footage and gathering local intelligence, they said.

The murder occurred on the evening of April 14 in the MCD Colony area, when the victim, identified as Rajeev, was attacked, they added.

The police received information about the stabbing at around 7.44 pm at Samaypur Badli Police Station. Rajeev, a tempo driver, was rushed to a hospital in Shalimar Bagh but succumbed to his injuries.

Preliminary investigation revealed that the dispute began on April 13, when a group of locals gathered near the victim's residence, leading to a heated exchange.

"The confrontation intensified the following evening when the group returned and attacked Rajeev with a knife," a senior police officer said.

The police registered a case at the Samaypur Badli station and took up an investigation. The team successfully traced and apprehended six juveniles, with a 15-year-old identified as the one who allegedly inflicted the fatal injury. The others are aged between 14 and 16.

The motive behind the crime appears to be a personal grudge. A day before the inci-



KEY POINTS

» The dispute began on Apr 13, when a group of locals gathered near the victim's residence, leading to an argument

» The confrontation intensified the following evening when the group returned and attacked Rajeev with a knife'

» The team successfully traced, apprehended 6 minors, with a 15-year-old identified as the one who allegedly inflicted the fatal injury: Cops

dent, the main accused and his grandmother had an argument with Rajeev and his father.

Derogatory remarks made during the argument are suspected to have triggered the retaliatory attack, police said.

Further investigation is underway, with efforts being made to identify and apprehend any other individuals involved in the case, police said.

Missing thirteen-year-old from Shahbad Dairy found after interstate search, social media link under probe

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Anti-Human Trafficking Unit (AHTU) of the Delhi Police's Crime Branch has rescued a 13-year-old girl who was allegedly lured through social media by a boy, underlining the growing online risks faced by children.

According to officials, the minor had gone missing from the Shahbad Dairy area on Jan-

uary 22, raising serious concern due to her age. An FIR was registered on January 25, following which a dedicated AHTU team launched a focused search operation.

Led by Inspector Manoj Dahiya and supervised by ACP Suresh Kumar, the team used a combination of technical surveillance, field intelligence and coordinated raids to track her movements across state lines.

Investigations revealed

that the girl had befriended a boy on Instagram.

Over time, the interaction developed into a sense of trust, eventually leading the boy to travel to Delhi and persuade her to leave with him. The two then travelled to Sikar in Rajasthan, raising fears of potential exploitation.

Acting on digital leads and surveillance inputs, police teams conducted multiple raids in Rajasthan before tracing the

girl's movement back to Delhi. She was eventually located and safely rescued from the ISBT Sarai Kale Khan area, bringing relief to her family.

Officials said the timely intervention helped prevent a potentially dangerous situation.

They also highlighted a rising trend of minors being influenced by strangers online, sometimes leading to elopement or exploitation.

STUDENTS MISS BOARD EXAMS

Principal held month after chairman in Ggm fake CBSE accreditation case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GURUGRAM: More than a month after Gurugram Police arrested the chairman of a private school for allegedly defrauding students by showing them fake CBSE accreditation up to Class 10, the principal of the school has now been arrested in the same case.

The action followed an FIR filed by the parents of a Class 10 student against the principal, directors and others connected to the Educruist International School in Sector 9B, after she was denied an admit card for her board exams, police said on Sunday.

According to police, the principal, Riddhima Kataria from Basai village, fled to Gujarat after the FIR was lodged, from where she has now been



arrested. The matter first came to light on February 17 when 11 Class 10 students missed their CBSE mathematics board examination after not receiving admit cards, police said.

A case was registered against the management of the school on February 18, they said.

In his complaint, the father of the Class 10 student alleged that the school management defrauded his daughter by not issuing her an admit card despite regularly charging various fees. The complain-

A case was registered against the management of the school on Feb 18

ant alleged that at the time of admission, the school management claimed to be CBSE-accredited and even showed an accreditation certificate and registration number.

But the registration number shown was also incorrect, a lapse that cost his daughter a year besides jeopardising her future, the complainant said.

Many parents of Class 10 students also alleged that the school management falsely claimed to be CBSE-accredited, but when their children

did not receive admit cards for the board exams, it was found that the school was not accredited by the CBSE up to the tenth grade.

Based on the complaints, police booked school chairman Vinay Kataria, principal Riddhima Kataria, vice principal Simar Batra, coordinator Sonia and other staff members under the relevant sections of the BNS. Kataria was arrested from Bilaspur in the district on March 6, police said.

During interrogation, Kataria revealed he had been running the school for eight years with CBSE recognition only up to Class 8.

He allegedly used a fake Class 10 accreditation to enrol 25 students in Classes 9 and 10, misleading parents and students.

Police busts counterfeit engine oil unit; 2 caught

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has arrested two men after busting a counterfeit engine oil manufacturing unit operating in east Delhi's Ghazipur, an official said on Sunday.

Rakesh Kumar Chhabra (52) and Kuldeep Singh (52), both residents of Delhi, were arrested during a raid at a godown on Thursday, in which police recovered around 700 litres of duplicate engine oil, packed and labelled as popular brands, he said.

"The seizure included 28 oil cans of 20 litres each and 140 bottles of one litre each, along with more than 550 empty bottles of various brands, stickers, coupons, barcodes, labels, and other packaging material," a senior police officer said.

A bottle sealing machine, drum, buckets, funnels, filter meshes, and other equipment used in the manufacturing

The seizure included 28 oil cans of 20 litres each and 140 bottles of one litre each

and packaging of counterfeit oil were also recovered from the premises, he said.

Preliminary investigation revealed that the accused were involved in manufacturing and supplying duplicate engine oil in the market under the labels of reputed brands, the officer said. Chhabra ran a garments business in Haryana, which shut down during the Covid-19 period, while Singh quit his job as a truck driver due to health issues, following which both got involved in the illegal trade in 2022, police said.

Efforts are underway to identify others involved in the supply chain, they said.

FOCUS ON INVESTMENT AND SKILLING

Delhi govt drafts semiconductor policy

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major push to position the national capital at the forefront of India's high-tech revolution, the Delhi government has initiated the drafting of its Semiconductor Policy, aiming to attract global investments, boost innovation, and generate high-skilled jobs in cutting-edge technology sectors.

Led by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the proposed policy seeks to establish Delhi as a key hub for semiconductor design, research and development, and advanced packaging activities. The initiative aligns with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of an Atmanirbhar Bharat and aims to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem with active participation from the Capital.



DDA wraps 'Harit Manthan 2026'

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Development Authority (DDA), in collaboration with the Udhmodya Foundation, has successfully concluded the first edition of its national-level hackathon, Harit Manthan 2026, aimed at reimagining urban green spaces through innovation and policy thinking.

Held on April 17 and 18, the two-day event brought together nearly 50 teams from 31 colleges across seven States, competing under Technology and Policy tracks. The initiative sought to generate practical, scalable solutions for ecological maintenance and sustainable urban development.

Inaugurating the second day, Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu highlighted the importance of youth-driven ideas in shaping resilient urban ecosystems. DDA Vice-Chairman N. Saravana Kumar noted that the hackathon represents a long-term institutional effort to integrate innovation into governance systems rather than a one-off exercise.

Participants were mentored by experts from DDA and the University of Delhi, with a focus on refining proposals for real-world applicability, scalability, and financial feasibility. The final round saw shortlisted teams present their ideas before an expert jury.

The event was attended by Dr. Payal Mago, Director, Campus of Open Learning, and Dr. Abhishek Tandon, CEO of Udhmodya Foundation, underscoring the growing synergy between academic institutions and public agencies.

Three winning teams two from the Technology track and one from Policy were awarded seed funding of up to Rs 10 lakh along with incubation support. Other promising teams will continue to receive guidance, with the possibility of future funding. Managing over 16,000 acres of green spaces in Delhi, DDA views the initiative as a step towards building a sustained pipeline of implementable ideas for a greener and more resilient capital.

City Briefs

ILLEGAL GROUNDWATER EXTRACTION IN NAJAFGARH: NGT NOTICE TO GOVT

NEW DELHI: The National Green Tribunal has sought a response from the Delhi government and others on the alleged large-scale illegal extraction of groundwater in Najafgarh. The green body was hearing a plea claiming unauthorised extraction by "private tanker mafia" operators in a plot in the Pankaj Garden locality of the area. In an order dated April 13, a bench of NGT Chairperson Justice Prakash Shrivastava and expert members A Senthil Vel and Afroz Ahmad noted the plea alleging "collusion and inaction on the part of the authorities", including the Delhi Jal Board (DJB). "Issue notice to the respondents," the bench said. The respondents in the matter include the Delhi government, DJB, the sub-divisional magistrate and district magistrate concerned, Delhi Police, Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC) and others. The matter has been posted to July 10 for further proceedings.

DELHI TEEN ELOPES TO RAJASTHAN WITH BOY SHE MET ON SOCIAL MEDIA, RESCUED

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has rescued a 13-year-old girl who went missing from outer Delhi in January after she left home with a boy she had befriended on social media, police said on Sunday. The girl, from the Shahbad Dairy area, had been missing since January 22, they said, adding that three days later, the police had registered a case. "During the inquiry, it was found that she had come in contact with the boy through the social media platform and later left with him. She was taken to Sikar in Rajasthan," a police officer said. She was eventually traced and brought back to Delhi, where she reunited with her family, he added.

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Led by CM Gupta, the proposed policy seeks to establish Delhi as a key hub for semiconductor design, research and development, advanced packaging activities
- » The initiative aligns with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of an Atmanirbhar Bharat and aims to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem with active participation from the Capital
- » 'The semiconductor sector has emerged as a critical

pillar of the global economy, and the Delhi Government is working on a comprehensive policy framework to ensure its balanced and structured development'



conductor Assembly and Testing (OSAT), talent development, and strengthening the startup ecosystem.

Emphasising Delhi's role in the semiconductor value chain, Gupta said, "The policy is expected to strengthen Delhi's position in high-value segments such as design, research and development, and advanced packaging," adding that it would attract investments from fab-less companies, startups, and global players.

The Chief Minister also underscored the employment potential, stating, "The policy will generate high-quality job opportunities in areas such as chip design, semiconductor research, and advanced packaging, while promoting skill development through training programmes and industry-academia partnerships."

Focusing on investment, the government plans to introduce targeted incentives, reduce operational costs, and create a conducive business environment. Measures like capital subsidies and infrastructure support, along with alignment to the India Semiconductor Mission, are expected to boost investor confidence.

Reiterating alignment with the Prime Minister's vision, Gupta said, "Semiconductors are not merely industrial products but form the foundation of technological sovereignty, national security, and economic strength," expressing confidence that Delhi will emerge as a key contributor to India's semiconductor growth story.



Oppn anti-women: CM Rekha Gupta

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Sunday launched a sharp attack on the opposition over recent developments in Parliament concerning the Women's Reservation Bill, calling the situation "deeply unfortunate" and a setback for women's rights in the country.

Addressing a press conference at the BJP office, Gupta questioned the narrative around democratic success, saying, "Daughters of this country are still fighting for their rightful place. And yet, what we are being told is that this is a victory of democracy. How can democracy claim victory when daughters lose?"

Taking aim at opposition parties, she said, "Those who gave the slogan 'Ladki hoon, lad sakti hoon' are now standing against women's rights," accusing them of abandoning their earlier stance. She further alleged that the Women's Reservation Bill had been obstructed repeatedly over the past three decades. "At different points, it was torn, stalled, even symbolically burned. This time too, the opposition ensured it did not pass by manufacturing arguments," she said.

Highlighting provisions of the 2023 law, Gupta noted that implementation of women's reservation is linked to delimitation. "If this condition was accepted then, why oppose it now? This contradiction must be answered," she said. Questioning the demand for reservation within existing seats, she asked, "Which of the current male representatives is ready to give up his seat?"

The Chief Minister also underlined the need to expand Lok Sabha seats, stating, "Today, we are nearing 150 crore. Redistribution and expansion of seats is no longer optional, it is necessary." She dismissed demands for a "quota within quota," calling it an excuse to delay women's entry into legislatures.

Targeting the Congress, Gupta said, "Their current stand is nothing but political pretence," and described it as the "All India Anti-Reform Congress" for opposing key reforms.

Raising concerns over delays, she said, "Why should women have to wait another five to ten years for their rights?" adding, "Iron becomes stronger when it is forged, and gold shines brighter when tested by fire. Our daughters too will emerge stronger through struggle."

Max temp settles at 40.1 deg C

NEW DELHI: Delhi on Sunday recorded a maximum temperature of 40.1 degrees Celsius, 3.3 notches above the seasonal average, according to the India Meteorological Department.

The minimum temperature settled at 21.7 degrees Celsius, 0.1 notches below the season's average, it said.

The weather department has predicted mainly clear sky for Monday with the maximum and minimum temperatures expected to touch 41 and 21 degrees Celsius, respectively.

Relative humidity was recorded at 35 per cent at 5.30 pm. The air quality was recorded in the 'poor' category at 4 pm, with an Air Quality Index (AQI) reading of 258, the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) data showed.

According to the CPCB, an AQI between zero and 50 is considered 'good'; 51 and 100 'satisfactory'; 101 and 200 'moderate'; 201 and 300 'poor'; 301 and 400 'very poor'; and 401 and 500 'severe'. MPOST

Bawana gets roads, water projs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a major push to strengthen rural infrastructure, Delhi Minister Ravinder Indraj Singh on Sunday inaugurated two key development projects in Bawana constituency, addressing long-pending demands for water supply and road connectivity in Prahlad Vihar and Dariyapur Kalan.

A water pipeline project, built at an approximate cost of Rs.45 lakh, was launched in Prahlad Vihar, ending a wait of nearly 15 years. The project ensures access to clean and uninterrupted water supply for thousands of residents, providing a permanent solution to drinking water shortages in the area. Locals, especially women, elderly citizens, and children, are expected to benefit significantly from improved access to this basic necessity.

In another major development, the minister also inaugurated the newly constructed Phirni Road in Dariyapur Kalan, built at a cost of around Rs.5.73 crore. The road, connecting Dada Maldev Talab to Nangal Mor Road in Bawana,



resolves a nearly 20-year-old demand and is expected to significantly improve connectivity, reduce travel time, and ease traffic movement in the region.

Both projects were undertaken with support from the Delhi Village Development Board and the Irrigation and Flood Control Department. Officials said the initiatives mark a step forward in improving basic infrastructure in rural and semi-urban areas of the capital.

Addressing residents, Singh said the government remains committed to ensuring equitable development and access to essential services. He emphasised that strengthening infrastructure in villages and rural areas continues to be a priority, adding that more development works will be undertaken in the coming time. Residents welcomed the projects, saying they would improve daily life and bring long-awaited relief to the community.

MCD seals polluting units in Shahdara, reviews works in Najafgarh

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) intensified its enforcement and infrastructure monitoring efforts across the Capital, sealing multiple polluting units in Shahdara and reviewing civic works in Najafgarh.

In a stringent action in Ward No. 246, Sadatpur, under the Shahdara North Zone, MCD teams sealed 16 industrial units for violating environmental norms. Officials said 12 of these units were involved in water-polluting activities, while four were found contributing to air pollution. The units were engaged in operations such as chemical processing and jeans dyeing, which were found to be non-compliant with prescribed regulations. The civic body stated that the crackdown reflects its continued focus on curbing environmental violations and safeguarding public health. Authorities reiterated that strict action will be taken against units operating without adherence to pollution control norms. In a separate development, MCD officials conducted an on-ground inspection of desilting operations and road infrastructure works in Matiala Ward, Najafgarh Zone. The visit was carried out in the presence of the area Councillor and zonal officials.

During the inspection, the team assessed the pace and quality of ongoing works, issuing directions to ensure timely completion. Special emphasis was placed on efficient drainage systems and the construction of durable roads to improve public convenience, particularly in view of the upcoming monsoon season.

The MCD maintained that it remains committed to strengthening civic infrastructure, enhancing service delivery, and ensuring cleanliness and environmental compliance across all zones of the city.



Delhi govt plans centres to aid construction workers

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government will set up "Karmik Sewa Kendras" across the city, based on the Passport Seva Kendra model, for registration of construction workers and delivery of services and welfare schemes to them.

According to officials on Sunday, the Delhi Building and Other Construction Workers Welfare Board (DBOCWWB) has begun the process of engaging an agency to design and develop 13 static and 13 mobile KSKs to cater to the migrant and local labour population in the city. The initiative is aiming to support nearly 30 lakh people, especially those belonging to vulnerable sections such as migrant workers and those employed in unorganised sectors, they added.

The selected agency will also develop 39 Labour Chowks, three each in Delhi's 13 districts, to facilitate various schemes of the welfare board throughout the national capital, they said.

The need for establishing the KSKs has been identified due to the persistent challenges faced by workers in accessing critical worker-related services, said an official document.

"By creating a network of service centres modelled on the Passport Seva Kendra (PSK) framework, the project aims

'The need for establishing the KSKs has been identified due to the persistent challenges faced by workers in accessing critical worker-related services'

to mitigate these issues significantly," it said.

The plan behind the setting up of Karmika Seva Kendra has drawn inspiration from the "highly successful" Passport Seva Kendra (PSK) model, which transformed passport services in the country, said a senior Delhi government officer.

By enhancing accessibility, efficiency, and worker satisfaction through time-bound registrations and maintaining proper records of the eligible workers to whom the benefits of welfare schemes are to be delivered, the KSK project seeks to replicate similar success as achieved by the PSKs, he said. The initiative aims to reduce wait times, improve service delivery standards, and ensure a high degree of worker satisfaction by providing streamlined, efficient, and user-friendly services related to workers, officials said.

In addition, the establishment of Labour Chowks under

the project will provide a structured and organised platform for workers to access employment opportunities, basic amenities, and welfare-related services at designated locations, they said.

According to the documents, the KSK facilitation centres will be technologically equipped and house completely Artificial Intelligence-based Digital Seva Kendras, with minimal manual interface, so that the process can operate autonomously, it said.

The centres will track all details, including medical check-ups, kits or other welfare schemes initiated by the board and DBT benefits, of the workers from the time of registration till the end of their membership, it said.

Self-help sensitive kiosks will also be installed at service centres to facilitate the workers, said the document. The KSKs will offer a holistic set of services designed to streamline and enhance the accessibility of worker-related services.

The services include formal registration as well as the renewal of labour cards by the workers within state and national databases at these Centres. The mobile KSK centres will extend the reach of services to outlying rural parts of Delhi, while the static KSKs will cater to urban and semi-urban areas, the official said.

LEE WILL ALSO MEET PREZ MURMU

Confident PM Modi-Prez Lee talks to bolster strategic ties with S Korea: EAM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Sunday called on South Korean President Lee Jae Myung as he kicked off his visit to India, and asserted that the visiting leader's talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi will boost the special strategic partnership between the two countries.

In a post on X, Jaishankar also shared some photos of his meeting with President Lee.

"Honoured to call on President @Jaemyung_Lee of the Republic of Korea as he begins his State Visit to India. Value his commitment to deepen India-Korea relations across multiple domains.

"Confident that his talks tomorrow with PM @narendramodi will further strengthen our Special Strategic Partnership," Jaishankar wrote.

The South Korean presi-



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar with South Korea's President Lee Jae Myung during a meeting, in New Delhi

dent began his three-day state visit to India on Sunday to bolster bilateral ties in trade, defence and critical technologies, etc.

According to the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), President Lee will hold talks with Prime Minister Modi on Monday on strengthening

bilateral cooperation across a wide spectrum of areas, including shipbuilding, trade, investments, AI, semiconductors, critical and emerging technologies and people-to-people connect.

They will also exchange views on regional and global issues of mutual interest. The

Highlights

» The South Korean president began his three-day state visit to India on Sunday to bolster bilateral ties in trade, defence and critical technologies, etc

» According to MEA, President Lee will hold talks with Prime Minister Modi on Monday on strengthening bilateral cooperation across a wide spectrum of areas

» 'Both leaders will also exchange views on regional and global issues of mutual interest. The prime minister will host a lunch in honour of the visiting leader'

» The India-South Korea strategic ties have been on an upswing for the past several years

prime minister will host a lunch in honour of the visiting leader, the MEA said.

Lee will also meet President Droupadi Murmu, who will host a banquet in his honour.

"The visit of President Lee underscores the shared aspiration of both countries to

further strengthen the existing areas of cooperation while expanding collaboration in new and emerging areas of mutual interest," the MEA said in a statement on Thursday.

The India-South Korea strategic ties have been on an upswing for the past several years.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

PUNE: The Maharashtra CID will incorporate a Zero FIR lodged by NCP (SP) MLA Rohit Pawar in Bengaluru into its ongoing investigation into the January 28 plane crash that killed then Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Ajit Pawar, a senior officer said on Sunday.

Rohit Pawar had lodged the "Zero" FIR last month under Section 173(1) of the Bharatiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita, weeks after the fatal incident.

The complaint was later sent to the Baramati Taluka police station in Pune district, which has since forwarded it to the CID, police said.

A Zero FIR is a first information report (FIR) registered at any police station, regardless of whether the crime was committed within its jurisdiction.

Rohit Pawar had claimed that he had to lodge the 'zero FIR' in Karnataka as the police

Key Points

» A Zero FIR is a first information report (FIR) registered at any police station, regardless of whether the crime was committed within its jurisdiction

» The Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AARB) under the Ministry of Civil Aviation is conducting a separate inquiry and submitted its preliminary findings on February 28

in Maharashtra did not register a case on his complaint regarding the Baramati air crash.

A Pune Rural Police officer confirmed that the Baramati Taluka police station had received the Zero FIR from Bengaluru Police and referred it to the CID.

"The CID is already probing an Accidental Death

Report registered with Pune Rural Police following the crash. The Zero FIR received from Bengaluru will be treated as a statement under Section 180 of the BNSS and factored into our probe," said Maharashtra CID chief and Additional Director General of Police Sunil Ramanand.

Section 180 of the BNSS deals with the examination of witnesses by police during an investigation.

A Learjet 45 aircraft, operated by VSR Ventures Pvt Ltd, crashed at Baramati airport on the morning of January 28 while en route from Mumbai to Baramati, killing Ajit Pawar and four others.

The Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AARB) under the Ministry of Civil Aviation is conducting a separate inquiry and submitted its preliminary findings on February 28.

As part of the standard procedure, Pune Rural Police had registered an ADR, setting the CID probe in motion.

DIGITAL ARREST SCAMS

CBI to launch chatbot to help people verify notices issued to them

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: To tackle the menace of digital arrest frauds, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) will on Monday unveil an artificial intelligence-powered chatbot that will help people verify the authenticity of notices issued to them.

The chatbot, 'Abhay', will be launched by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant on the occasion of the 22nd D P Kohli Memorial Lecture organised by the CBI in honour of its founding director, officials said.

The CJI will deliver the lecture on 'Challenges of Cyber Crime - Role for Police and Judiciary'. He will also confer 24 Medals for Meritorious Service.

"The AI-powered notice verification chatbot, ABHAY, will allow the public to verify the genuineness of a notice purportedly issued by the CBI. In the context of digital arrest frauds, this provides a much-required tool for the citizens," a CBI spokesperson said.

In a number of cases, it has emerged that scammers posing as CBI officials have coerced the public by showing fraudulent notices purportedly issued by the agency in non-existent

ing cases, holding the victim hostage in the name of digital arrest and extorting crores of rupees in the process, the spokesperson said.

The Supreme Court had recently flagged that Rs 54,000 crore was siphoned off by cyber criminals in various scams and termed the menace "robbery or dacoity".

Organised since 2000, the D P Kohli Memorial Lecture has seen addresses by many eminent personalities.

"Born in 1907 in Uttar Pradesh, Kohli joined the police service in 1931 and went on to serve with distinction in multiple regions and the government of India. He led the Delhi Special Police Establishment (DSPE) from 1955 and became the founding director of CBI upon its establishment on 1st April 1963, serving until his retirement in 1968," the CBI said in a statement.

The lecture brings together eminent speakers from diverse fields to share insights on law enforcement, criminal justice and investigative challenges. It serves as a platform for dialogue and knowledge-sharing and advancing the understanding of modern policing and accountability, it said.

TCS case: Kin of accused call him 'high-performer'; blame office politics, jealousy for allegations

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NASHIK: Internal professional rivalry and office politics are the motive for the "false" sexual harassment and conversion allegations levelled against TCS employee Raza Rafiq Memon, his family said here on Sunday, describing him as a "high performer".

Speaking to news agency, Memon's uncle Ayaz Kazi said the case was part of a coordinated "conspiracy" spurred by Memon's academic and professional performance.

Memon, currently in police custody till April 20, is among eight persons arrested after allegations of sexual harassment and pressure to convert emerged at a unit of Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) in Nashik.

He led the team that included both the complainant and prime accused Danish Shaikh.

Memon's family said the primary allegations are against Shaikh, and if he is guilty, then he must not be spared.

"However, the allegation against my nephew may be part of a coordinated conspiracy driven by academic and professional performance," Kazi said. Memon hails from a humble background and topped an internal exam at the firm last year, which could have triggered jealousy among the other colleagues,

the uncle said.

"He became a topper, and that didn't sit well with others in the company. This looks like a frame-up born out of office politics," he said.

Kazi described his nephew as "helpful," citing chats between the complainants and Memon that he said show he allowed them to leave early for their personal reasons.

Memon always obliged and would coordinate with the other team members, he said.

"As a team leader, his focus was strictly on sales targets and team productivity. There was no indication of any inappropriate interaction outside of these professional requests," he added.

Memon's family members also made claims of communal discrimination in the case against him. Kazi claimed that the people above Memon in the hierarchy were from different faiths, yet no action had been taken against them.

He said that Memon's inclusion in the matter is a "planned conspiracy" to derail the careers of high-performing employees.

A family member of another accused called him innocent. He has been "framed" because he used to hang out with Danish, the relative said. "He is a practising person and could not have done such a thing," the family member said.

From Page 1

Trump sends Vance-led

had shifted stances on issues that derailed the last round of negotiations, including Iran's nuclear enrichment programme, its regional proxies and control over the Strait of Hormuz.

Trump repeated his threats against Iranian infrastructure that have drawn widespread criticism and warnings of war crimes. If Iran doesn't agree to the US-proposed deal, "the United States is going to knock out every single power plant and every single bridge in Iran," he wrote.

Ships remained unable to transit the critical waterway amid threats from Iran and a U.S. blockade on ships heading to and from Iranian ports. Roughly one-fifth of the world's oil trade normally passes through the strait, and the global energy crisis threatened to deepen as the war is now in its eighth week.

Iranian officials earlier on Sunday held firm that ships wouldn't pass while the US blockade remained in effect. "It is impossible for others to pass through the Strait of Hormuz while we cannot," Qalibaf said.

In his post about talks, Trump accused Iran of violating the ceasefire by firing at ships transiting the strait. Iran has called the US blockade a violation, and foreign ministry spokesperson Esmail Baqaei on Sunday called it an "act of aggression".

Iran had announced the strait's reopening after a 10-day truce between Israel and the Iranian-backed Hezbollah militant group in Lebanon took hold on Friday. But Iran said it would continue enforcing its restrictions there after Trump said the US blockade "will remain in full force" until Tehran reaches a deal with the US.

After a brief uptick in transit attempts on Saturday, Iran fired on two India-flagged merchant ships that were forced to turn around, leading India to summon Iran's ambassador over the "serious incident". India noted that Iran earlier let several India-bound ships through.

For the Islamic Republic, the strait's closure — imposed after the US and Israel launched the Iran war on Feb 28 during talks over Tehran's nuclear programme — is perhaps its most powerful weapon, inflicting political pain on Trump. For the United States, the blockade squeezes Iran's already weakened economy by denying it long-term cash flow.

The war has killed at least 3,000 people in Iran, more than 2,290 in Lebanon, 23 in Israel and more than a dozen in Gulf Arab states. Fifteen Israeli soldiers in Lebanon and 13 US service members throughout the region have been killed.

Since most supplies to US military bases in the Gulf region come through the strait, "Iran is determined to maintain oversight and control over traffic through the strait until the war fully ends," Iran's Supreme National Security Council said late Saturday. That means Iran-designated routes, payment of fees and issuance of transit certificates. The council has recently acted as Iran's de facto top decision-making

body.

Meanwhile, Pakistani Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar, who spoke by phone with Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi on Sunday, has said his country was working to "bridge" differences between the US and Iran.

Iranian Deputy Foreign Minister Saeed Khatibzadeh on Saturday told The Associated Press that the US is "risking the whole ceasefire package" with its blockade.

Khatibzadeh said Iran won't hand over its stock of 970 pounds (440 kilograms) of enriched uranium to the United States, calling the idea "a nonstarter". The deputy minister didn't address other proposals for the enriched uranium, saying only that "we are ready to address any concerns."

Indian tanker

in its statement, adding that the issue was raised directly with Iranian authorities.

According to the United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations, a tanker was approached and fired upon by two Iranian Revolutionary Guard Corps gunboats about 20 nautical miles northeast of Oman. Monitoring agencies also reported that at least two India-linked vessels, including a supertanker carrying Iraqi crude, had to turn back.

AGENCIES

Virudhunagar

triggered a massive fire and caused extensive structural damage.

The force of the blast reduced at least three rooms to rubble and levelled several nearby structures. "We have recovered 23 bodies so far, many of which were charred beyond recognition," a police official said. Authorities said they were yet to determine the identities or even the sex of several victims due to the condition of the remains.

Among the six injured, four are reported to be in critical condition and are undergoing treatment at the Virudhunagar Government Medical College Hospital. Three of the injured are women who sustained around 60 per cent burn injuries, officials added.

Fire and rescue services personnel battled the blaze for several hours as intermittent bursts of firecrackers continued long after the initial explosion, complicating rescue efforts. Officials fear that more workers may still be trapped beneath the debris, and search operations remain underway.

The tragedy is being described as the deadliest industrial accident in the region this year. It comes within days of another explosion in the district's Vembakkottai area that left four people dead.

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M K Stalin expressed grief over the loss of lives and said he had directed senior ministers to visit the site. In a post on X, he said the news of the explosion causing multiple deaths had brought "immense sorrow" and conveyed his condolences to the bereaved families.

He added that Ministers K K S S R Ramachandran and Thangam Thennarasu had been asked to rush to the site to oversee rescue operations and provide support to affected families. Stalin also said he had spoken to the district collector and instructed officials to ensure all necessary assistance.

Leader of the Opposition in

the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi also expressed his condolences, stating that the victims were workers who had left home to earn a livelihood. He wished a quick recovery for those injured. Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi Vadra similarly conveyed her grief, offering condolences to families and prayers for the injured.

Authorities said further details would emerge as rescue operations continue.

LPG consumption

LPG allocations to commercial users, including hotels and industrial units, in order to prioritise household consumption. Data from the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell (PPAC) showed domestic LPG sales fell 8.1 per cent to 2.219 million tonnes in March. Sales to non-domestic users dropped by nearly 48 per cent, while bulk LPG consumption plunged 75.5 per cent.

The figures indicate lower overall consumption despite government statements that household demand continued to be met without disruption.

To address the shortfall, authorities instructed refineries to divert feedstock away from petrochemical production to increase LPG output. As a result, domestic production rose to 1.4 million tonnes in March, up from 1.1 million tonnes a year earlier. For the full 2025-26 fiscal year, LPG production increased to 13.1 million tonnes, compared with 12.8 million tonnes in each of the previous two years.

Despite the March dip, annual LPG consumption maintained an upward trend, rising 6 per cent to 33.212 million tonnes in the fiscal year ending March 2026. Growth has been supported by policies promoting cleaner cooking fuels over traditional options such as firewood.

The impact of the conflict was also visible in aviation fuel demand. Consumption of jet fuel, or ATF, remained nearly unchanged at 807,000 tonnes in March, compared to 801,000 tonnes a year earlier, amid flight disruptions and airspace restrictions in parts of the Gulf.

In contrast, demand for transport fuels remained strong. Petrol consumption rose 7.6 per cent to 3.78 million tonnes, while diesel use increased 8.1 per cent to 8.727 million tonnes in March.

For the full fiscal year, ATF demand grew 2 per cent to 9.161 million tonnes. Petrol consumption increased 6.5 per cent to 42.586 million tonnes, and diesel rose 3.6 per cent to 94.705 million tonnes. Among industrial fuels, naphtha demand fell 9.9 per cent and fuel oil declined 1.4 per cent, while bitumen consumption grew 3 per cent to 8.84 million tonnes.

India, US chief negotiators

since the agreement has not been signed, we have got the option where we can right now change whatever needs to be changed," the source added.

The talks may also address two ongoing unilateral investigations initiated by the US Trade Representative under Section 301 of US trade law. India has rejected the allegations in these probes and has called for their termination, arguing that the notices lack adequate

justification.

Under the earlier framework, the US had proposed reducing tariffs on Indian goods to 18 per cent from 50 per cent. It had also withdrawn a 25 per cent tariff linked to India's purchase of Russian oil and planned to cut the remaining 25 per cent to 18 per cent. In return, India had offered to reduce or eliminate tariffs on US industrial goods and a broad range of agricultural products, including dried distillers' grains, red sorghum, tree nuts, fruits, soybean oil, wine and spirits.

India had also indicated plans to import goods worth USD 500 billion from the US over five years, spanning energy, aircraft and parts, precious metals, technology products and coking coal.

However, with all US trading partners now facing a flat 10 per cent tariff, India's earlier advantage over competing countries has narrowed, prompting the need for adjustments.

Trade data reflects shifting dynamics as well. China emerged as India's largest trading partner in 2025-26, overtaking the US, which had held the position for four consecutive years until 2024-25. India's exports to the US rose marginally by 0.92 per cent to USD 87.3 billion in the last fiscal year, while imports increased by 15.95 per cent to USD 52.9 billion. The trade surplus with the US narrowed to USD 34.4 billion from USD 40.89 billion a year earlier.

Dinesh Trivedi

career diplomat Pranay Verma, who moves to Brussels as the Indian envoy to the EU.

Trivedi, known as an astute politician with considerably long experience in governance and politics, as India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh marks a departure from the conventional postings that go only to Indian Foreign Service (IFS) officers.

His appointment indicates the BJP-led NDA government's desire and top priority to improve relations with Bangladesh which came under severe strain under the chief advisor Mohammed Yunus-headed interim government after the ouster of Sheikh Hasina-led Awami League government.

Trivedi has his roots in West Bengal as well as wide and deep political connections that may come handy in engagements with political channels.

"Congratulations to Shri Dinesh Trivedi, senior BJP leader, former Union Minister and Barrackpore MP, for being appointed as India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh," BJP leader Amit Malviya said in a post on X.

Earlier this month, Bangladesh Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman undertook his first visit to India after the new government came to power in Dhaka. He indicated New Delhi and Dhaka are not starting from scratch but from memory of a relationship shaped by shared rivers, shared borders, and the kind of cultural proximity that makes formal diplomacy feel almost redundant.

No highway parking

the bench observed, adding that the right to life under Article 21 includes an obligation to ensure

'TMC TRYING TO FORM GOVT OF INFILTRATORS'

This Assembly election is to save Bengal's identity, says PM Modi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

JHARGRAM: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday asserted that the upcoming Assembly election in West Bengal was a battle to save the state's identity, accusing the Mamata Banerjee government of pursuing politics that favoured "infiltrators" over the native population.

Addressing a rally in the tribal-dominated Jhargram district ahead of the April 23, Modi alleged that the TMC wanted to form a "government of infiltrators and for infiltrators", urging voters to unite to remove it from power.

"This election is to save the rich heritage of this land. It is for saving the identity of Bengal. Today, there is fear of Bengal losing its identity," he said. "The path that the TMC is treading is very dangerous. The TMC wants to form a gov-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi tries 'jhalhuri', street snack made of puffed rice, on the sidelines of public meetings ahead of the West Bengal Assembly elections, in Jhargram PTI

Highlights

- » The PM claimed resentment against the TMC govt had spread across communities and regions of state
- » PM alleged that TMC leaders were illegally occupying tribal land in several parts of the state

ernment of infiltrators and for infiltrators. A government that will protect only the religion of infiltrators, the language of infiltrators and the customs of infiltrators, rather than those of the people of Bengal," he alleged.

Modi claimed that for such a government, the biggest obstacle would be the ordinary

people of West Bengal.

"For the TMC's infiltrator government, if there is any enemy, it will be the brothers and sisters sitting here," he said.

The PM claimed resentment against the TMC government had spread across communities and regions of the state.

"Therefore, every commu-

nity, every class, every region of Bengal has resolved this time, and has taken a pledge to oust this TMC government," he claimed.

Sharpening the BJP's pitch in the tribal belt, Modi accused the TMC of neglecting the region despite being in power for 15 years.

"You gave 15 years to the ruthless TMC government. Fif-

teen years is no small amount of time. What has the TMC government given you? What have the tribal areas received? No education, no income, no medicine and no irrigation. Everything here is in dire straits," he alleged.

The PM alleged that TMC leaders were illegally occupying tribal land in several parts of the state.

Modi said 'Van Dhan Kendra', community-owned centres to train tribals for value addition to minor forest produce, would be expanded if the BJP came to power.

He said the BJP would promote homestays and ecotourism in Jhargram, and the Centre has already taken steps to improve rail connectivity through Vande Bharat and Amrit Bharat trains.

He, however, claimed the pace of development was being slowed by the state government.

Delimitation, not women's Bill, defeated, asserts Congress

'Implement quota immediately on current LS strength'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Closer Look

- » Shrinete pointed out that the women's reservation Bill was passed unanimously by Parliament on September 21, 2023
- » 'PM shedding crocodile tears and hiding behind the women's reservation Bill'

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Sunday accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi of shedding "crocodile tears" over the issue of reservation for women and demanded that the quota be implemented immediately on the current strength of the Lok Sabha.

The Opposition party also asserted that what was defeated in the Lok Sabha on April 17 was not the women's reservation Bill but delimitation.

Congress spokesperson Supriya Shrinete pointed out that the women's reservation Bill was passed unanimously by Parliament on September 21, 2023, and it is part of the Constitution now. "The women's reservation Bill was not defeated, the delimitation, which you (government) wanted to thrust on the nation, was defeated," she said at a press conference here.

"PM Modi is shedding crocodile tears and hiding behind the women's reservation Bill,"

she said.

Shrinete displayed a cartoon, which showed the PM having a basket with 543 mangoes, but refusing to give women a 33 per cent share and telling them that he can give them their share only if he can increase the number to 850, which the Opposition is not letting him do.

On the PM's address to the nation over the rejection of the Constitution amendment Bill in Parliament, the Congress leader reiterated her party's stand that if he was really sincere, he should immediately provide reserva-

tion to women within the current strength of the Lok Sabha of 543.

"You have put a condition on that. Remove that condition. You are the ones creating hurdles in women's reservation, you want to keep men happy and not reduce their seats," she said, hitting out at the government.

Referring to Modi apologising to women, Shrinete said the PM was right as he does owe an apology to the women of the country for what happened to two Manipur women during riots, what happened in Hathras and Unnao, what happened with the women Olympians and how the convicts in the Bilkis Bano case were honoured.

"You were right. Women won't forget their insults. Who else knows it better than you?" she said.

Shrinete said of the 240 MPs, only 31 are women, which is only 12 per cent. Of the 1,654 legislators across the country, there are only 164 women, which is less than 10 per cent.

Govt's attempt to use women's quota as weapon boomeranged on it: TN CM

HOSUR: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M K Stalin on Sunday alleged that Prime Minister Narendra Modi's bid to use the Women's quota as a weapon against the Opposition parties, amidst polls in states including Tamil Nadu, has boomeranged on him.

Addressing an election rally here, Stalin flayed PM Modi for allegedly bashing the Opposition during his televised address to the nation on April 18 on the Women's Reservation issue.

Despite the tricolour forming the backdrop to the address



Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge with Tamil Nadu Chief Minister MK Stalin, in Hosur PTI

and when the Model Code of Conduct was in force due to polls, Modi chose his address to slam Opposition parties, he

said.

Stalin, also the DMK president, alleged: "What must have been spoken in an election rally has been spoken by the prime minister in an official government address, and this is a blatant violation of rules. He has been speaking like this as he was tense due to the first defeat of the government in the Parliament (in the constitutional amendment Bill issue)."

Meanwhile, Chief Minister Stalin on Sunday unveiled the DMK's 'Chennai Super-6', a Chennai-specific manifesto for the Assembly polls. MPOST

Women's reservation: Cong, DMK 'betrayed' women, BJP will ensure justice, says Amit Shah

OUR CORRESPONDENT

ERODE: Union Home minister Amit Shah on Sunday lashed out at the Congress and DMK for voting against the Women's Reservation amendment Bill in the Lok Sabha, accusing them of "betraying" women from getting the quota in Parliament and state Assemblies.

However, the Prime Minister Narendra Modi's government would not allow the "conspiracy" to succeed and ensure justice for the women of the country, he said.



Union Home minister Amit Shah campaigns ahead of the Tamil Nadu Assembly elections, in Chennai, Sunday PTI

Addressing a roadshow here in support of his party's Modakurichi candidate for the April 23 Assembly polls, Kirthika Shivkumar, the senior BJP leader, also expressed confidence of the NDA forming a government under the leadership of AIADMK chief Edappadi K Palaniswami in the state post the polls.

"The Congress and DMK have certainly deprived sisters and mothers across the country, in Tamil Nadu (of reservation) in Parliament and Assemblies. There was a

chance for 50 per cent (Lok Sabha) seat increase for Tamil Nadu. But they have conspired to reduce Tamil Nadu's seats by insisting on their increase based on 2026 census."

"But on behalf of PM Narendra Modi, I want to assure the people of Tamil Nadu that we will not allow this conspiracy of the Congress and DMK to succeed. We will definitely ensure justice for the people of Tamil Nadu, the women of Tamil Nadu," Shah said.

He also hit out at the ruling DMK's first family for "dynastic politics."

'PM's address violated Model Code of Conduct'

NEW DELHI: Left parties have written to Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, alleging that Prime Minister Narendra Modi's address to the nation on Saturday violated the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) for elections and seeking action against him.

CPI(M) General Secretary MA Baby and CPI Rajya Sabha MP P Sandosh Kumar wrote separately to the poll panel chief, alleging misuse of the public broadcaster to influence public opinion in states where polling is scheduled in coming days. MPOST

आवेदन शुरू
16 अप्रैल 2026

अंतिम तिथि
30 अप्रैल 2026

उम्मीदों के पंख और हौसलों की उड़ान, हेमन्त सरकार दे रही नया आसमान

कमर्शियल पायलट लाइसेंस (CPL)
ट्रेनिंग - सत्र 2026-27 में प्रवेश प्रारंभ

सोना सोबरन उड़ान अकादमी (झारखण्ड फ्लाइटिंग इंस्टीट्यूट)
भविष्य के युवा पायलटों से आवेदन आमंत्रित करता है
युवा अत्याधुनिक सुविधाओं और अनुभवी प्रशिक्षकों के साथ अपने करियर को नई उड़ान दे सकेंगे

कोर्स की मुख्य बातें

- **कोर्स:** CPL (मल्टी इंजन रेटिंग एवं इंस्ट्रूमेंट रेटिंग के साथ)
- **प्रशिक्षण स्थल:** दुमका, झारखण्ड
- **सुविधाएं:** आधुनिक सिम्युलेटर, ग्राउंड स्कूल और हॉस्टल सुविधा उपलब्ध

प्रवेश हेतु पात्रता

- **ऊंचाई:** 158 - 185 सेमी
- **शिक्षा:** 10+2 (PCME) न्यूनतम 50% अंकों के साथ (आरक्षित वर्ग हेतु 45%)
- **अनिवार्यता:** DGCA के कम से कम 04 थ्योरी पेपर उत्तीर्ण होना आवश्यक

आवेदन प्रक्रिया: इच्छुक उम्मीदवार आवेदन फॉर्म वेबसाइट www.jharkhandaviation.in से डाउनलोड कर सकते हैं। भरा हुआ फॉर्म ₹1200 के डिमांड ड्राफ्ट के साथ स्पीड पोस्ट या व्यक्तिगत रूप से कार्यालय में जमा कर सकते हैं

संपर्क करें: स्टेट हैंगर, बिरसा मुंडा एयरपोर्ट, रांची
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सूचना एवं जनसंपर्क विभाग, झारखण्ड

PAHALGAM TERROR ATTACK ANNIV

Security tightened at Kashmir tourist spots



A security personnel keeps vigil as tourists visit a spot at Pahalgam in Anantnag, on Sunday

MPOST BUREAU

SRINAGAR: Security has been beefed up at tourist spots across Kashmir ahead of the first anniversary of the Pahalgam terror attack in which 26 people were shot dead by Lashkar-e-Taiba terrorists on April 22 last year, officials said here.

All security agencies have been asked to remain alert for any possible subversive activities on the eve of the Pahalgam terror attack anniversary, especially around tourist spots, they said. Preparatory meetings to devise a foolproof security plan were held at the ground level while senior officers recently reviewed these arrangements.

On April 22, 2025, a dastardly terrorist attack ripped through the quaint Baisaran meadow in Pahalgam, killing 25 tourists and a local pony-ride operator.

The brutal attack carried out by Lashkar-e-Taiba terrorists led to an exodus of tourists from Jammu and Kashmir, prompting the authorities to shut nearly 50 tourist spots before reopening some of those in a phased man-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Security agencies have been asked to remain alert for any possible subversive activities on the eve of the Pahalgam attack anniversary
- » On April 22, 2025, a dastardly terrorist attack ripped through the quaint Baisaran meadow in Pahalgam, killing 25 tourists and a local pony-ride operator

ner after a security audit.

Now, about a year down the line, the famed meadows of Pahalgam are once again buzzing with tourist activity, with none ruining their decision to visit the 'Mini Switzerland' in Anantnag district that is overcoming the shadow of last year's terror attack.

Several new measures have been introduced in Pahalgam resort to ensure tourist safety. These include antecedent verification of service providers and

vendors, including ponywal-lahs, before they interact with the visitors.

A unique QR code-based identification system has been introduced for all tourism service providers for the safety of tourists in Pahalgam.

The system enables easy identification and verification of genuine and registered service providers, including pony-ride operators, hawkers, business establishments, as well as outside vendors.

"Each service provider has been properly vetted by police, registered by the authorities and has been provided a unique QR code that contains personal information and other details about that person," the officials said.

When tourists scan the code with their mobile phones, they can check complete information about the person concerned, they added.

The QR codes contain the service provider's name, parentage, detailed address, mobile number, Aadhaar number, registration number, operational route, and whether they are police-verified.

North India sizzles as mercury crosses 40 degrees Celsius amid heatwave alert

IMD warns of heatwave conditions in parts of UP in the coming days

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Many places across northern states including Delhi on Sunday recorded above-normal temperatures crossing 40 degrees Celsius during the day, while the India Meteorological Department warned of heatwave conditions in parts of Uttar Pradesh in the coming days.

However, Jammu and Kashmir saw a dip in temperatures with fresh snowfall in the higher reaches and rainfall in the plains. A western disturbance is likely to provide similar relief with a wet spell in the mid and high hills of Himachal Pradesh on Monday, Friday and Saturday, according to the Shimla MeT office.

In Uttar Pradesh, cities including Prayagraj, Varanasi, Sultanpur, Agra, Barabanki,



People shield themselves from the scorching heat in Prayagraj

Bahraich, Shahjahanpur and Hardoi recorded temperatures significantly above normal, indicating the onset of heat-wave conditions.

Prayagraj recorded a high of 44.6 degrees Celsius, followed by Varanasi at 44.2 degrees Celsius and Banda at 43.6 degrees Celsius. Several other

districts including Sultanpur, Barabanki and Bahraich also reported temperatures above 42 degrees Celsius. According to the Meteorological Centre in Lucknow, dry westerly winds in the lower troposphere over interior Maharashtra are causing a gradual increase in temperatures.

Barring the Terai region adjoining Uttarakhnad, maximum temperatures have crossed 40 degrees Celsius in most parts of the state.

In Haryana as well, maximum temperature settled above normal in several parts, with Rohtak being the hottest place at 42.3 degrees Celsius, the meteorological office said.

The maximum temperature in Rohtak was five degrees above normal. Neighbouring Punjab similarly witnessed above-normal temperatures.

Bathinda was the hottest place in the state with a maximum temperature of 41.3 degrees Celsius. Ludhiana recorded a high of 40 degrees Celsius and Patiala 40.5 degrees Celsius.

In Rajasthan, Kota recorded the highest maximum temperature at 42.1 degrees Celsius.

DGCA official held in bribery case: CBI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested a Deputy Director General from the Airworthiness Directorate at the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) headquarters in New Delhi, along with a representative of a private firm, in an alleged bribery case.

According to officials, the case relates to a demand of Rs 2.5 lakh to expedite regulatory clearances pending with the civil aviation authority. The alleged bribe was sought through unofficial channels, prompting a complaint and subsequent action by the agency. Acting on the inputs, the CBI laid a trap and caught the accused red-handed while accepting the bribe. The entire amount of Rs 2.5 lakh was

recovered from the spot.

Following the arrests, the agency conducted searches at four locations in Delhi linked to the accused officials and private entities.

During the raids, investigators seized around Rs 37 lakh in cash, along with gold and silver coins and several electronic devices believed to contain crucial evidence.

Both accused are being questioned as part of the ongoing investigation. Officials said the seized materials are being examined to establish the extent of the alleged corruption network and identify any additional links.

The CBI is also probing whether more officials or private entities were involved in the case. Further details are expected to emerge as the investigation progresses.

Punjab govt's anti-sacrilege Bill becomes law after Guv's assent

The legislation is a decisive step to uphold the sanctity of religious scriptures and maintain communal harmony

CHANDIGARH: The Punjab government has officially implemented the 'Jaagat Jot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Saktar Amendment Bill', with the Governor of Punjab granting assent to the legislation mandating life imprisonment for those found guilty of desecration of Sri Guru Granth Sahib.

Addressing a press conference at Punjab Bhawan on Sunday, Cabinet minister Harpal Singh Cheema termed the legislation a decisive step to uphold the sanctity of religious scriptures and maintain communal harmony. He alleged that incidents of sacrilege had occurred during the tenure of the Shiromani Akali Dal-Bharatiya Janata Party government, citing the 1986 Nako-dar case and the 2015 Bargari and Behbal Kalan incidents.

Cheema said successive

individuals who earlier enjoyed political protection have had to seek anticipatory bail," he said, asserting that all those involved would be brought to justice, irrespective of status.

Cheema said the amended law is designed to be stringent and comprehensive, holding not only those directly involved in acts of sacrilege but also conspirators accountable. He added that the legislation addresses the defence of "mental instability" often cited in such cases.

In instances where the accused is under guardianship, the guardian can also be held liable for negligence.

Calling it a key promise fulfilled by the state government and Arvind Kejriwal, Cheema said the law sends a strong message against attempts to disturb Punjab's social fabric.

MPOST

HP: Rs 70L penalty imposed on Chester Hill project

ASHWANI SHARMA

SHIMLA: The multi-crore Chester Hill project, already under scrutiny over alleged violations and 'benami' charges, has suffered another setback with action by the Himachal Pradesh Real Estate Regulatory Authority (HP RERA).

HP RERA has imposed an interim penalty of Rs 70 lakh on the promoters of two housing projects—Chester Hills-2 and Chester Hills-4—for violations of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016. The authority levied Rs 35 lakh each on the projects under Section 60 of the Act.

The action followed a suo motu case initiated after media reports and an inquiry conducted by the SDM, Solan. The authority found violations of provisions mandating proper maintenance of accounts for funds received from homebuyers and expenditure incurred on the projects.

Officials said further action could follow once detailed field reports are examined. "We have sought a report from the field. If irregularities are found, additional penalties may be imposed," a senior RERA official said.

Complaints against the projects include irregularities in the formation of Residents Welfare Associations, poor maintenance, deviations from approved plans, and handing over possession without obtaining occupancy certificates. HP RERA has also flagged possible violations under multiple provisions of the Act, including obligations of promoters, deviations from sanctioned plans, and issues related to premature possession. If confirmed, these could attract stricter penalties.

The inquiry report pointed to serious financial irregularities, including the absence of project-wise accounting, intermingling of funds from allottees, and lack of audited financial statements.

Haryana CM attacks Oppn for 'blocking' women's quota Bill

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Sunday accused Opposition parties of obstructing the 'Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam' in Parliament, alleging their actions hindered women's rights and reflected an "anti-women mindset." He also claimed that the Congress had historically limited itself to symbolic gestures on women's reservation without concrete action.

Speaking at a press conference in Rohtak, Saini said the Opposition resisted the Bill on April 16 and 17, calling it "undemocratic" and a setback for half of India's population. He named parties such as the Samajwadi Party, Trinamool



Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini addresses a press conference in Rohtak on Sunday

Congress and Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam, accusing them of putting politics above women's empowerment. West Delhi MP Kamaljeet Sehrawat and BJP state president Mohan Lal Kaushik were also present.

Saini said the Centre introduced three Bills in the Lok Sabha on April 16—the Con-

stitution (131st Amendment) Bill, the Delimitation Bill and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill—to fast-track 33 per cent reservation for women. He noted that while the original provision linked implementation to the Census and delimitation, the government chose to delink it to ensure the benefit could be extended by the 2029 general elections.

Praising Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Saini termed the move a "bold decision" to ensure women's rightful participation in governance. He also accused the Opposition of spreading misinformation on delimitation despite clarifications by Union Home Minister Amit Shah that no state's representation would be reduced.

LeT's 'Khargosh' found in Saudi Arabia

'Umer Harris manages to escape the country using forged passport'

INSIGHT

- » Contrary to earlier reports stating that Harris hailed from Karachi, it has emerged that he is from Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
- » He joined the LeT to evade police prosecution as he had several arson cases pending against



him in Karachi
» He was later pushed by the terror group into Jammu and Kashmir in 2012

group into Jammu and Kashmir in 2012.

Harris earned the alias 'Khargosh' as he could hop from place to place in no time, evading the security dragnet.

According to investigations and interrogations of the arrested accused, Harris, after infiltrating the Kashmir Valley from the northern side, stayed at various locations in Bandipora and Srinagar and married the daughter of an LeT Over Ground Worker (OGW). The Nikah ceremony was held in Jaipur under his assumed name, Sajjad.

Officials stated that the marriage documents were also used to support his application

for an Indian passport.

The unravelling of this inter-state terror module by the Srinagar Police has exposed several loopholes. Questions are being raised about how a passport was issued by authorities in Rajasthan despite the police verification system in place. The LeT terrorist managed to flee to Indonesia, from where he is believed to have used another forged travel document to station himself somewhere in Saudi Arabia in 2024–25, the officials said.

They said efforts are being made through diplomatic channels to bring him back to India and seek his deportation from the Gulf country.

UP CM Yogi slams Oppn for 'anti-women' stance

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Sunday accused Opposition parties of having an anti-women mindset, saying their position on the women's reservation law exposes their reluctance towards women's empowerment.

Addressing a joint press conference in Lucknow along with Union minister Annapurna Devi, the chief minister defended the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam and launched a sharp political attack on parties, including the Samajwadi Party and Congress.

Annapurna Devi alleged that the Samajwadi Party was indulging in appeasement politics by seeking reservations for Muslim women. She said the Constitution does not permit reservation on religious grounds and

Akhilesh Yadav targets BJP on women's quota law

LUCKNOW: Akhilesh Yadav on Sunday launched a sharp attack on the BJP over the women's reservation legislation, alleging that the ruling party was attempting to turn "nari" into a political slogan rather than ensuring real empowerment.

Addressing the media in Lucknow, the Samajwadi Party chief said the Opposition had prevented the BJP from succeeding in its "agenda." He questioned how the government could implement reservation for women without conducting the Census. Yadav said that

if the government goes ahead with a census, demands for a caste-based census would also gain momentum. He alleged that the government was reluctant to ensure equitable rights. "We want to give rights to half the population, but who will decide which half gets the benefit," he said.

The SP chief claimed that the Opposition now represents the true voice of the country. He accused the BJP of dividing society into smaller groups and then creating fear among them for political gains.

MPOST

accused Opposition parties of misleading the public.

Adityanath described the law as a major step towards empowering women and said Opposition resistance was driven by caste-based politics. Referring to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, he said the government considers women, youth, the

poor and farmers as the foundation of its governance agenda. The CM also targeted parties such as Congress, Samajwadi Party, RJD, Trinamool Congress and DMK, accusing them of obstructing reform measures. He said the Centre had ensured that the implementation of the law would not adversely impact

any state and that increasing the number of seats was part of this process.

Adityanath said their stance was against the spirit of the Constitution. He also referred to past issues such as the Shah Bano case to allege that Congress had a history of failing to protect women's rights.

'More security forces to arrive in Manipur after Bengal polls'

IMPHAL: Manipur Home minister Govindas Konhoujam on Sunday said additional security forces would arrive in the state after the West Bengal elections.

Konhoujam said, "272 companies of CAPF were deployed in the state, including at different routes. However, 88 companies have been withdrawn due to elections in other states. We have been told that another 15 companies will be withdrawn, but after the chief minister highlighted the concern to central authorities, the Union Home ministry said no further companies will be withdrawn. So, 184 companies of CAPF are currently being retained."

He said: "Mine and bulletproof vehicles have already started coming. After the Bengal elections on April 23 and April 29, all the withdrawn forces along with additional forces and those apt in counterinsurgency will arrive in the state."

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UNDER DETENTION IN UAE

'Key drug trafficking suspect Jaswinder may soon walk free'

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI/DUBAI: Jaswinder Singh, also known as "Jazz", an alleged key operative in a transnational drug trafficking network linked to India, could be released in the UAE due to delays in the submission of evidence, sources said.

Singh, a British national with ancestral roots in Punjab's Jalandhar, was detained by UAE authorities on March 23 following an Interpol notice. However, under local legal provisions, the requesting country must submit supporting documents within a stipulated period, typically around a month. Failure to do so can result in the accused being granted temporary release or discharge.

Officials indicated that procedural and administrative delays have slowed the transfer of crucial evidence from India, impacting the progress of the case. While specifics remain unclear, sources acknowledged that the lag in documentation has put the extradition process

at risk. Investigative agencies in India are reportedly reviewing the matter, particularly the delay in compiling and forwarding key case files. Singh is suspected of being involved in narcotics operations spanning regions such as Punjab and areas near Greater Noida, though gathering admissible evidence has taken longer than expected.

According to sources, Singh had been operating out of Dubai for several years, allegedly coordinating drug shipments to India and exploring avenues to expand production and distribution networks internationally. His activities are believed to be part of a broader cross-border syndicate with links extending beyond the region. The case has drawn attention amid concerns flagged by Indian security agencies about the wider implications of international drug trafficking networks. Officials have previously warned that proceeds from such activities could be diverted toward destabilising operations.



EDITORIAL
CRISIS BREWING

The global aviation industry is staring at a crisis that goes far beyond rising ticket prices. The war involving Iran and the effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz have triggered a looming jet fuel shortage that could disrupt air travel across Europe and Asia within weeks. What began as a geopolitical flashpoint is rapidly translating into an economic shock, one that could hit ordinary travellers, airlines, and national economies alike. The warning from International Energy Agency (IEA) Director Fatih Birol—that Europe may have barely six weeks of jet fuel supplies left—should be read not as alarmism, but as a signal of how deeply interconnected energy flows and global mobility have become.

Jet fuel, a refined product of crude oil, is the single largest cost component for airlines, accounting for nearly 30 per cent of their expenses. When prices double—as they have since the conflict escalated—the ripple effects are immediate. Airlines operate on thin margins, and any sustained increase in fuel costs inevitably gets passed on to consumers. Already, carriers across regions have begun embedding higher fuel costs into ticket prices, increasing baggage fees, and imposing surcharges. The result is predictable: costlier travel, fewer affordable options, and a shrinking accessibility of air mobility, particularly for middle-class passengers.

However, the issue is no longer confined to pricing alone. As supplies tighten, the risk of physical shortages looms large. Europe's dependence on the Strait of Hormuz—through which a significant share of its jet fuel imports passes—has exposed a structural vulnerability. With no jet fuel shipments moving through the strait since the onset of the conflict, inventory levels are depleting. Reports suggesting that some European countries have less than 20 days of fuel coverage point to a scenario where airlines may soon be forced to cancel flights, reduce frequencies, or alter routes. What is unfolding is not merely a market adjustment but the early signs of systemic disruption.

The implications extend well beyond Europe. Asia-Pacific nations, which rely heavily on Middle Eastern oil, are equally exposed. While the United States, as a major oil producer, may cushion some of the global impact through increased exports, this is only a partial and temporary fix. The closure of the Strait of Hormuz has reportedly removed between 10 million and 15 million barrels of oil per day from the global supply chain. No amount of short-term redistribution can fully offset such a massive disruption. Even the release of emergency reserves by the IEA, though significant in scale, may take months to translate into usable supply in the market.

For airlines, this evolving crisis is forcing a fundamental rethink of operations. It is no longer just about absorbing higher costs; it is about redesigning networks in an uncertain environment. Longer routes to avoid conflict zones, reduced scheduling flexibility, and unpredictable demand patterns are becoming the new normal. Early signs are already visible. Airlines such as KLM have begun cutting flights deemed financially unviable, while others are accelerating fleet rationalisation to retire less fuel-efficient aircraft. The industry is entering a phase where operational prudence will take precedence over expansion.

For travellers, the consequences will be both immediate and visible. Higher fares are only the beginning. The summer travel season, typically marked by peak demand, may instead witness volatility in schedules, last-minute cancellations, and a noticeable reduction in low-cost options. The aviation market could shift towards late bookings and uncertain itineraries, eroding the predictability that modern air travel has long promised. For many, especially those travelling for work or family commitments, this uncertainty could prove as disruptive as the financial burden.

For India, the situation carries particular significance. As one of the world's fastest-growing aviation markets, India is deeply integrated into global travel and energy networks. Indian carriers, already grappling with cost pressures and competitive pricing, will find it difficult to shield passengers from the impact of rising fuel costs. The imposition of additional surcharges by airlines such as Air India is an early indicator of what may lie ahead. More importantly, India's broader economic interests are at stake. Disruptions in global aviation can affect trade, tourism, and connectivity, all of which are critical to the country's growth trajectory.

This crisis also underscores a deeper strategic lesson. The Strait of Hormuz has long been recognised as one of the world's most critical energy chokepoints, yet the scale of global dependence on it remains stark. The current disruption is a reminder that energy security is not merely about securing supplies but also about ensuring resilient and diversified supply chains. For countries like India, this calls for a renewed focus on strategic reserves, alternative energy partnerships, and long-term investments in energy diversification.

At a broader level, the unfolding situation reflects the fragile equilibrium of globalisation. The seamless movement of goods, people, and resources that the world has come to rely on is underpinned by geopolitical stability. When that stability is disrupted, the consequences cascade across sectors. Aviation, often seen as a symbol of global connectivity, becomes one of the first casualties. The present crisis, therefore, is not just about fuel shortages; it is about the vulnerability of interconnected systems in an increasingly uncertain world.

There is still a window to mitigate the worst outcomes. Diplomatic efforts to ease tensions, coordinated international responses to manage energy flows, and proactive measures by governments and industry stakeholders can help cushion the blow. But time is of the essence. Every day that the Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed brings the world closer to a deeper crisis.

In the final analysis, the message is clear. The jet fuel shortage is not an isolated disruption but a warning signal. It highlights the urgent need for resilience in energy systems, adaptability in industry practices, and prudence in policymaking. For travellers, it may mean paying more and planning cautiously. For governments and industries, it must mean preparing better for a world where shocks are no longer exceptions, but an increasingly frequent reality.

TALKING SHOP



RAJEEV NARAYAN

THE WRITER IS A VETERAN JOURNALIST AND COMMUNICATIONS SPECIALIST

No country can claim any sort of economic ascent when its workers earn less than basic survival requires. Any nation's growth without its people's dignity staying intact is not development; it is tantamount to callous extraction

STRATEGIC OUTLOOK



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS A RETIRED IPS OFFICER, ADVISER NATSTRAT, AND A FORMER NATIONAL SECURITY ADVISOR IN MAURITIUS

As Dhaka and New Delhi reopen channels, the challenge lies in converting diplomatic warmth into durable trust and long-term regional cooperation

India's growth story stutters and falters when its basic workers cannot survive on paltry wages. It also lays bare a culture of ruthless, entrenched exploitation

"Growth means little if those who build it can't afford to live."
— Martin Luther King, Jr.

The boiling point has been reached, and it has been crossed. This anger did not arrive overnight. It has been building in the shadows of factory floors, behind locked gates and under the hum of assembly lines. But when it surfaced on the streets of Noida, Gurugram, Bhiwadi and other parts of the nation, it carried with it something far deeper than economic grievance. It carried indignation. It also carried resentment that asked a simple, unsettling question: Why are corporations unapologetic even when they pay wages that are measly and do not allow workers to survive with basic dignity?

For long, we have been speaking of Viksit Bharat and an ambitious pathway to becoming a developed nation. But murmurs are growing that this vision has drifted from the lived realities of millions, for development cannot be measured through aggregate growth or headline GDP expansion. It must be felt in the hands and homes of ordinary citizens. India's per capita income of around Rs 2,500 a month, tells a sobering story, for this is the metric that matters: income in the hands of the common people. When that remains constrained, not only are lives diminished, but the broader economy is denied the very consumption demand that sustains growth. India's current income trajectory shows a widening imbalance, with wealth accumulating at the top and relief remaining elusive at the bottom.

This has seen a resurgence of worker protests in the nation's industrial belts. What began as scattered strikes has coalesced into a pattern, seeking a bare wage of Rs 20,000 a month, demanding humane working conditions and pushing back against what workers describe as daily indignities. The triggers are immediate – LPG prices, food inflation and other insolent by-products of geopolitical tensions, but the cause is older. All of 79 years after Independence, India still confronts an awkward truth; that the 'Colonial Raj' may



India's current income trajectory shows a widening imbalance, with wealth accumulating at the top and relief remaining elusive at the bottom

have ended, but a subtler and more pervasive 'Management Raj' persists. It governs not through law, but through leverage. It extracts quietly and efficiently, but invisibly. The Silent Squeeze

The numbers betray a story that policy debates often obscure. Statutory minimum wages in several parts of India – Rs 7,000-9,000 per month for various skill categories – are not just inadequate; they are detached from reality. Even with revisions, such as the hikes announced in Haryana to bring wages closer to Rs 15,000-18,000, the gap between earnings and living costs remains gigantic. Workers are not merely asking; they are pleading for survival.

The dissonance sharpens when juxtaposed against the macroeconomic narrative. India is described as one of the fastest-growing major economies, a manufacturing alternative in global supply chain and a rising industrial power. Yet, at the base of this growth pyramid are workers who struggle to afford cooking gas, rent and basic nutrition. Labour groups and trade unions have flagged this, pointing not just to low wages but to systemic issues such as contractualization, low bargaining power and poor enforcement of labour laws. In most factories, half the workforce is hired on contract, often through intermediaries, diluting accountability and depressing wages. This is not an economic distortion; it is a structural imbalance. One that allows profitability to coexist with precarity.

Contract Chains

If there is a single thread that binds the current unrest, it is the rise of the contract worker.

Employers argue that flexibility is essential in a competitive environment. Workers counter that this very flexibility has become a euphemism for disposability. The contract model fragments the workforce, weakens unions, diffuses responsibility and creates hierarchies within the workplace. Permanent employees retain relative security, while contract workers risk being replaced at short or no notice. The result is an ecosystem where vulnerability is institutionalised and invisibility is routine.

Industry bodies such as the Confederation of Indian Industry acknowledge this. Calls for state support for social security contributions for micro and small enterprises signal a recognition that compliance is uneven and burdensome. Yet such measures, while necessary, address only the surface.

The deeper issue is not regulatory complexity; it is moral complacency. For long, the question of wages has been framed as a negotiation between cost and competitiveness. Rarely is it framed as a question of dignity. Even more rarely does anyone ask why legal minimum wages fall short of ensuring even a basic standard of living.

Reluctant Reform

Recent wage hikes in some states, prompted by protests, reveal a troubling dynamic: that change occurs, but only under duress. Negotiations that follow unrest are not acts of progressive policy; they are reactive concessions. This raises a deep concern about governance. Labour laws may be extensive on paper, but enforcement remains inconsistent. Inspections

are sporadic, penalties inadequate and compliance uneven. In such an environment, adherence to minimum wage norms becomes less a legal obligation and more a matter of discretion.

Employers, on their part, point to rising input costs, global competition and thin margins, particularly in labour-intensive sectors. These are not trivial concerns. But they do not justify a system where the burden of adjustment falls disproportionately on those least equipped to bear it. The argument that businesses cannot afford higher wages sits uneasily alongside expanding corporate profits. It invites scrutiny not just of economic constraints, but of distributional priorities.

India's development story is at a crossroads. On one hand, there is undeniable progress – in expanding infrastructure, digital transformation and global integration. On the other is an undercurrent of inequality that threatens to undermine all gains. The paradox is stark, that a nation aspiring to be a global manufacturing hub cannot sustain a workforce and leaves it treading at the edge of subsistence.

Global frameworks, including those advocated by the International Labour Organization, emphasise the concept of a living wage, one that allows workers not just to survive, but to live with dignity. India's existing wage structures, even after revisions, fall short of this benchmark. The consequences extend beyond individual hardship. Low wages suppress consumption, limit human capital development and perpetuate cycles of poverty. They also create a fragile industrial ecosystem – one prone to unrest, disruption and reputational risk. In an interconnected world, where supply chains are scrutinised for ethical compliance, the cost of neglecting labour welfare is not only domestic, but strategic.

Needed: Mindset Shift

What this leaves us with is a question. And it is not whether India can afford to pay its workers better, but whether it can afford not to. The answer goes beyond wage revisions. It demands a fundamental shift in mindset: from viewing labour as a cost to recognising it

as a foundational asset. It calls for a recalibration of policy, enforcement and corporate practice.

For one, minimum wages must be aligned closely with living costs, with regular revisions reflecting inflation and regional variation. Second, enforcement must be strengthened to ensure transparency and accountability. Third, over-reliance on contractual labour must be addressed through regulations and safeguards.

Equally important is the role of corporate leadership. Compliance with the law is the baseline, not the benchmark. The test lies in whether companies are willing to go beyond minimum requirements and invest in the well-being of their workforce. Government, industry bodies and civil society must work in concert. Issues such as sharing the burden of social security contributions for smaller enterprises merit serious thinking. Above all, these efforts must be embedded in a framework that treats worker welfare as central to economic policy, not a peripheral afterthought.

Big Goals. Small Minds

There is need for a voice. Silence around worker exploitation – except when crisis erupts – reflects total indifference. Bringing such issues to light is not advocacy, but a prerequisite for accountability. India's aspirations are vast, its potential undeniable. But the true measure of its progress does not lie in GDP numbers or industrial output. It lies in whether those who carry the economy on their shoulders are able to live with dignity, and whether they can feed themselves and their families, and at least occasionally live a life beyond mere subsistence.

The protests unfolding across India's industrial belts are not disruptions to growth. They are warnings... portents that the distance between policy and reality has grown too wide, that the promise of Independence remains incomplete. Until those at the very bottom of the economic chain are lifted, India's story of rise will remain, at best, unfinished. And at worst, unjust and heartless.

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Beyond Strain, Towards Stability

Renewed high-level engagement signals an attempt to repair strained India–Bangladesh ties, with strategic, economic and regional stability considerations driving the reset

In a major diplomatic move, which does not seem to be a routine or an ordinary exercise, the Foreign Minister of Bangladesh, Khalilur Rahman, arrived in New Delhi on April 7 on a goodwill visit and met the Indian National Security Adviser, Ajit Doval, on the same day, followed by a dinner engagement. On April 8, the visiting Foreign Minister was expected to meet his Indian counterpart, S Jaishankar, to hold a wide range of bilateral talks. Other than meeting the Indian Foreign Minister, Khalilur Rahman was also scheduled to hold meetings with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal and Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri. Later, the Indian and Bangladeshi Foreign Ministers were also slated to travel together from New Delhi to Mauritius to attend the Indian Ocean Conference in Mauritius from April 10 to 12. The visiting Bangladesh Foreign Minister is accompanied by Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's adviser on Foreign Affairs, Humayun Kabir.

This visit is being seen as a clear signal on the part of both India and Bangladesh to recalibrate their ties, which needed a boost and repair, as they suffered severe damage ever since Sheikh Hasina quit power and an interim government was in place in Dhaka for nearly one and a half years. There is immense excitement and hope in the Bangladesh polity over the attempts to bring about a positive thaw in the bilateral relationship, which was long overdue. According to several editorials appearing in the Dhaka print media and many talk shows on electronic channels, the recent diplomatic engagements between Dhaka and New Delhi are certainly promising, signalling a determined effort to reset and revitalise a relationship that has long been central to Bangladesh's foreign policy.

According to *Dhaka Tribune*, India has historically been one of Bangladesh's closest allies, with ties



A cautious but necessary reset in India–Bangladesh relations comes at a moment when regional stability demands coherence, not drift

rooted in shared history, geography, and economic interdependence. Over the years, cooperation has expanded across sectors – from trade and connectivity to energy and security. Yet, recent political transitions and fledgling bilateral irritants have led to elements of strain, underscoring the need to improve relations. In this context, the renewed push for engagement is a welcome development. Constructive dialogue, such as discussions on energy cooperation and cross-border infrastructure, signifies a will to move beyond the past hiatus and focus on tangible outcomes. Plans for further high-level visits and continued diplomatic exchanges seem imperative amid a time of considerable global uncertainty, economic volatility, shifting geopolitical alignments, and energy insecurity, making regional cooperation a necessity. For Bangladesh, a stable relationship with India can provide critical support in areas including energy, trade diversification, and regional connectivity. And, for India too, according to a large section of the Bangladesh media, the latter remains a crucial partner in ensuring stability and growth in South Asia.

Some analysts, however, feel that the success of this new chapter will depend on more than diplomatic intent. It will require a balanced approach. Transparency,

consistency, and people-centric policies will be key in rebuilding trust. At a time when global challenges demand regional solidarity, a renewed Bangladesh–India partnership could prove to be both timely and transformative, and their collaborative efforts could possibly pave the way for a more constructive and meaningful role in resolving tensions in South Asia in particular.

Crucially, some political commentators, including prominent columnist Rishi Suri, opine that India has observed the developments carefully but with cautious optimism. The hard reality is that India has expectations from the new Bangladeshi leadership. History also suggests that Tarique Rahman is unlikely to be disappointed if he chooses to work with India as a trusted partner. Bangladesh's recent election itself represents a major turning point. The BNP secured 212 out of 300 parliamentary seats. The emergence of a new political leadership in Dhaka does not simply represent a change of government; it gives an opportunity to redefine the most significant bilateral relationship. India also needs to capitalise on this in the larger interest of both countries.

It is worth recalling that few bilateral relationships in the region are as deep or historically rooted as the one between India and Bangladesh. The bonding is fundamen-

tally shaped by the events of 1971, when India played a decisive role in Bangladesh's liberation from Pakistan, supporting the Mukti Bahini and helping establish an independent Bangladesh. That shared history continues to form the emotional and strategic foundation of ties. Today, the relationship is not merely historical or symbolic; it is deeply economic, strategic, and people-centric. India is Bangladesh's largest trading partner in South Asia, while Bangladesh has emerged as one of India's fastest-growing export markets. In the financial year 2023–24, bilateral trade reached approximately USD 14 billion, with Indian exports accounting for about USD 12 billion and Bangladesh exports nearly USD 2 billion.

This economic exchange reflects the scale of interdependence between the two economies. For Bangladesh's economy, this relationship has tangible benefits. India supplies a wide range of critical inputs to Bangladesh's export industries, particularly the globally significant ready-made garment sector. More than 80 per cent of Bangladesh's cotton yarn imports come from India, making Indian raw materials crucial for Bangladesh's textile industry, which employs millions of workers and drives the country's export earnings. The partnership goes far beyond trade. Over the past decade, India has extended more than USD 7.3 billion in concessional lines of credit to Bangladesh, the largest development assistance India has offered to any country. These funds have helped finance railways, bridges, energy infrastructure, and port connectivity projects across Bangladesh.

Yet another example is the Akhaura–Agartala railway line, a cross-border project designed to significantly reduce travel time between Kolkata and India's northeastern states while boosting trade and tourism. Similarly, the Mai-

tri Setu bridge linking Tripura with Bangladesh provides India's northeastern states direct access to the Chittagong port, reducing time and logistics costs and expanding regional commerce. Energy cooperation is another pillar of the relationship. The Bangladesh–India Friendship Pipeline, inaugurated in 2023, transports petroleum products from India to northern Bangladesh, helping stabilise Bangladesh's fuel supply while strengthening regional energy integration. India is also exporting electricity to Bangladesh through cross-border power grids, contributing to Bangladesh's growing energy needs.

Significantly, in March 2026, India released around 5,000 tonnes of diesel to Bangladesh under the existing bilateral supply arrangement, helping ensure stability in Bangladesh's fuel supply at a critical time. India must see stability and prosperity in Bangladesh as a strategic priority. A stable Bangladesh contributes to security in India's northeast, enhances connectivity with Southeast Asia, and strengthens regional economic growth across the Bay of Bengal region.

While details of the deliberations between both the Foreign Ministers are yet to reach us, by the time this opinion piece hits the stands, things could be clearer. The two countries must continue to enhance cooperation in the sharing of valuable and actionable information and also collaborate on anti-terrorism measures with increased professional coordination. In sum, the gains of this visit and the Bangladesh Foreign Minister's talks with his Indian counterpart, as also with the Indian National Security Adviser, merit consolidation to take decisions forward for further amelioration of bilateral ties with new dynamism, leaving no stone unturned to ensure that the warmed-up ties do not lapse into complacency.

Views expressed are personal

IRAN'S DEPUTY FM REJECTS CLAIMS MADE BY TRUMP

US ‘maximalist’ demands stall face-to-face talks: Iranian official

ANTALYA: Iran is not yet ready to hold a new round of face-to-face talks with US officials, a senior Iranian official said Saturday, citing Washington's refusal to abandon “maximalist” demands on key issues.

In an interview with The Associated Press on the margins of a diplomacy forum in Türkiye, Iranian Deputy Foreign Minister Saeed Khatibzadeh also said his country will not hand over its enriched uranium to the United States, rejecting claims made by US President Donald Trump.

“I can tell you that no enriched material is going to be shipped to the United States,” Khatibzadeh said. “This is a non-starter, and I can assure you that while we are ready to address any concerns that we do have, we’re not going to accept things that are nonstarters.”

On Friday, Trump said that the US will go into Iran and “get all the nuclear dust,” referring to the 970 pounds (440 kilograms) of enriched uranium believed to be buried under nuclear sites badly damaged by US military strikes last year.

Khatibzadeh said there have been many exchanges of messages between the sides, but



Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Saeed Khatibzadeh talks during an interview with Associated Press at the Antalya Diplomacy Forum, in Antalya

Highlights

» The Iranian official renewed Iran's position that Tehran's actions were defensive

» ‘Iran has no option, just to stop aggressors once and forever’

» Trump has said a US blockade of the Strait of Hormuz will remain

» Official also reiterated Iran's position that the ceasefire must extend to Lebanon

accused the United States of holding firm on demands Iran deems to be excessive.

“We are still not there yet to move on to an actual meeting because there are issues that the Americans have not yet abandoned their maximalist position,” Khatibzadeh said. Iran was seeking the finalisation of a “framework agreement” before moving to an in-person meeting, he added.

The Iranian official would not go into specifics of the negotiations with the United States or say which issues remain unresolved, but called

on Washington to address Iran's concerns, including sanctions imposed on Iran.

“The other sides also should understand and address our main concerns, which are illegal unilateral sanctions that Americans have imposed on Iranians and this economic terrorism which has targeted Iranian people to suffocate them and make them revolt against the political structure inside Iran,” Khatibzadeh said.

Asked whether Iran would respond to renewed attacks by Israel on Lebanon despite the ceasefire, Khatibzadeh said:

“Iran has no option, just to stop aggressors once and forever.”

Trump said that Israel is “prohibited” by the US from further strikes on Lebanon and that “enough is enough” in the Israel-Hezbollah war.

The State Department said the prohibition applies only to offensive attacks and not to actions taken in self-defence.

The Iranian official renewed Iran's position that Tehran's actions were defensive and in response to unprovoked aggression occurring in the middle of negotiations.

He also reiterated Iran's

position that the ceasefire must extend to Lebanon, where Israel had been fighting with the Iran-backed militant group Hezbollah.

When the US and Iran declared a temporary truce last week, Pakistan and Iran said it extended to Lebanon, but Israel — and later the US — denied this. Israel then launched a series of airstrikes on central Beirut, prompting Iran to announce it was once again closing the Strait of Hormuz. Following the implementation of a truce in Lebanon on Friday, Iran said it had reopened the strait. “Iran negotiated in good faith, accepted a ceasefire and told everybody that this ceasefire should include all countries, including Lebanon,” Khatibzadeh said. “Then the other side said that it is not committed to this and then started atrocities.”

He said that a “new protocol” would be put in place for the Strait of Hormuz as part of the negotiations with the US, and it would “remain open and safe for all civilian passage.”

Trump has said a US blockade of the Strait of Hormuz will remain, and attacks will resume if no agreement is reached with Iran.

Pak steps up security ahead of second round of US-Iran talks

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan has stepped up security in and around the national capital, as US President Donald Trump on Sunday announced that American negotiators will be there on Monday for peace talks with Iran.

The US and Iran held rare direct talks in Pakistan on April 11 and 12 in Islamabad aimed at ending their conflict, but the talks concluded without any agreement. In his Truth Social post on Sunday, Trump said that American negotiators will be in Pakistan on Monday for talks with Iran.

It was not immediately clear whether the American negotiating team will be led by Vice President J D Vance, who was in Islamabad for the first round of talks. “Jared Kushner and Steve Witkoff are heading to the Middle East,” Trump told Fox News. Special Envoy Witkoff and Kushner, Trump's son-in-law, had accompanied Vance during the first round of talks.

Even before Trump's announcement, the administration of Islamabad and Rawalpindi indicated the arrival of foreign delegates for talks.

“Due to the arrival of foreign delegations in Islamabad, Red Zone and Extended Red Zone will remain completely closed for all kinds of traffic,” Islamabad police said on its official X account.

“Citizens are advised to use



Iran's Parliamentary Speaker Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf (right), meets Pakistan's Army Chief Field Marshal Asim Munir in Tehran

“CITIZENS ARE ADVISED TO USE ALTERNATE ROUTES AND COOPERATE WITH TRAFFIC POLICE TO ENSURE SMOOTH FLOW AND SECURITY”

alternate routes and cooperate with traffic police to ensure smooth flow and security,” it said.

Earlier, a police spokesperson said more than 10,000 police personnel have been deployed and over 600 checkpoints have been established across Rawalpindi, the sprawling city adjacent to Islamabad, the Express Tribune newspaper

reported.

The security protocol is also being implemented in the capital city. Authorities have announced that from Sunday midnight, several sensitive areas surrounding Nur Khan Airbase and Islamabad International Airport will be sealed.

The Nur Khan Airbase is located in Rawalpindi while the Islamabad International Airport falls in the territorial jurisdiction of Attock district of Punjab province but the passengers have to pass through the Rawalpindi district area to reach Islamabad.

Hence, with mega security arrangements in Rawalpindi, authorities said they are not taking any chances after Trump last week said he may visit Pakistan for the signing of the agreement with Iran.

Italy: Two Indian men shot dead

ROME: Two Indian men have been shot dead in Italy's Covo in Bergamo province just as they were leaving a warehouse used as a place of worship during a gathering for Vaisakhi festival, local media reported on Sunday. The attack occurred on Friday, a few minutes before midnight in the square in front of the Gurdwara Mata Sahib Kaur Ji in the industrial area of the town, according to La Sicilia newspaper. The deceased were identified as Raginder Singh, 48, a resident of Covo, and Gurmit Singh, 48, from Agnadello. The assailant allegedly approached the men, opened fire and then fled in a car, the paper reported.

North Korea fires ballistic missiles towards sea coast

SEOUL: North Korea launched multiple short-range ballistic missiles toward the sea on Sunday, its neighbours said, days after the UN's nuclear watchdog warned that North Korea was making “very serious” advances in efforts to build nuclear weapons.

The missiles fired from the North's Sinpo area flew about 140 kilometres (87 miles) each in a direction toward the country's eastern waters, South Korea's Joint Chiefs of Staff said. It said South Korea maintains a readiness to repel any provocations by North Korea and is closely exchanging information with the US and Japan.

In an emergency meeting of the National Security Council, senior South Korean officials expressed concerns about

The US and Japanese militaries also said they detected launches

North Korea's repeated ballistic missile tests and urged it to stop them immediately.

Sunday's launches came hours before South Korean President Lee Jae Myung left the country to visit India and Vietnam.

The US and Japanese militaries also said they detected the launches.

The US Indo-Pacific Command said it remains committed to the defence of the US homeland and its allies in the region.

UK LEADER TO FACE RESTIVE LAWMAKERS TODAY - Allies back Starmer as Mandelson, Epstein leave UK PM fighting for his job

LONDON: Senior Cabinet ministers on Sunday rallied around UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer, whose leadership is teetering over his decision to give Britain's most important diplomatic job to Peter Mandelson, a scandal-tarnished politician and friend of Jeffrey Epstein.

Starmer will face restive lawmakers in Parliament on Monday to fight for his job after the explosive revelation that Mandelson was appointed ambassador to the United States despite failing security checks. Starmer says he's “furious” that he wasn't told at the time, in January 2025, that an intensive vetting process had recommended Mandelson not



UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer

be given security clearance. The Foreign Office, which oversees diplomatic appointments, cleared him anyway.

Deputy Prime Minister David Lammy said that if Starmer had known, “he would never, ever have appointed him

ambassador.” Technology Secretary Liz Kendall told Sky News on Sunday that Starmer “is a man of integrity and there is no way he would have proceeded” with Mandelson's appointment had he known. The top civil servant in the Foreign Office, Olly Robbins, was forced to resign on Thursday — though allies say he was just doing his job and is being made a scapegoat. Robbins is expected to give his own version of events to the House of Commons Foreign Affairs Committee on Tuesday.

Simon McDonald, who was the top civil servant in the Foreign Office until 2020, said Robbins had been “thrown under the bus.”

Louisiana shooting: 8 children between ages of 1 and 14 dead

SHREVEPORT: Authorities say eight children were killed in the “domestic disturbance.”

The victims ranging in age from one to 14 years old.

The shooting occurred around 6 am on Sunday, according to Shreveport Police Chief Wayne Smith. He said a total of 10 people shot.

Officials said they were still gathering details about the crime scene, which extended across three

locations.

Smith said the suspected shooter was fatally shot by police during a vehicle chase. Police said there were three related shooting scenes.

The first happened on W. 79th Street and the second on Harrison Street, both in Shreveport.

The third happened in Bossier Parish, Louisiana, on Brompton Lane, as per media reports.

Pope heads to Catholic shrine in Angola



Pope Leo XIV observes a 21 gun salute after arriving in Luanda

LUANDA: Pope Leo XIV called Sunday for Angolans to fight the “scourge of corruption” with a culture of justice as he opened a poignant day in his African odyssey that will take the American pope to an epicenter of the African slave trade. Leo celebrated Mass before an estimated 100,000 people outside the capital and again sought to encourage Angolans. He denounced the exploitation of their mineral-rich land and people, who still bear the scars of a brutal, post-independence civil war.

“We wish to build a country where old divisions are overcome once and for all, where hatred and violence disappear, and where the scourge of corruption is healed by a new culture of justice and sharing,” Leo said in his homily in Kilamba, a Chinese-built development about 25 kilometres (15 miles) outside the capital. Later Sunday, Leo will celebrate the Rosary prayer at the Sanctuary

Leo celebrated Mass before an estimated 100,000 people outside the capital and again sought to encourage Angolans

of Mama Muxima, an important Catholic shrine on the edge of the Kwanza River about 110 kilometres (70 miles) south of Luanda.

The Church of Our Lady of Muxima, built by Portuguese colonisers at the end of the 16th century as part of a fortress complex, became a hub in the slave trade.

It was where enslaved Africans were gathered to be baptised by Portuguese priests before being forced to walk to the port of Luanda to be put on ships to the Americas.

Declaration about criminal cases

(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018, of Hon'ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs. Union of India & Anr.)

Name and address of candidate : MITA BAG, Vill. & P.O.- Maigram, P.S.- Arambagh, Dist.- Hooghly, Pin- 712602, W.B

Name of political party : ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS.

(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)

Name of Election : LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY 2026

*Name of Constituency : 200, ARAMBAGH (SC) ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY.

I, MITA BAG (name of candidate), a candidate for the abovementioned election, declare for public information the following details about my criminal antecedents :

(A) Pending criminal cases				
Sl. No.	Name of Court	Case No. and dated	Status of case(s)	Section(s) of Acts concerned and brief description of offence(s)
1	Judicial Magistrate, 3rd Court	Court case No G.R. No.- 772 / 2016,		Sections 448 /506/ 34 IPC Punishment for House-trespass & Punishment for Criminal Intimidation
2	Judicial Magistrate, 3rd Court	Court case No. G.R. No.- 1888 / 2016,		Section 365 / 506 / IPC Punishment for Kidnapping & Punishment for Criminal Intimidation
(B) Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences				
Sl. No.	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed	Maximum Punishment Imposed	
	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	
	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	
	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.

Trump wants to stop states from regulating AI

About 8 in 10 people in US say they were ‘concerned’ or ‘very concerned’ about AI

RIVERTON: When a dozen Republican activists gathered on a back deck in the Salt Lake City suburbs to talk about this year's elections, the conversation cycled through all the staples of conservative chatter in Utah such as dwindling water supplies, illegal immigrant fraud and chemtrail conspiracy theories. But Doug Fiefa, a state representative running to be a state senator, wanted to start with something else — artificial intelligence. Fiefa used to work at Google and, like several other tech employees who have gone into politics, he has made regulating the industry a centrepiece of his campaign.

“I know it sounds like Doug, this is all you talk about,” Fiefa said. “That's because it's coming, it's here and it's going to be our biggest fight.”

Fiefa's focus has put him on a collision course with President Donald Trump's administration, which this year helped block his state proposal requiring companies to include child safety protocols.



US President Donald Trump

Key points

- » New York last year required major AI developers to report dangerous incidents to the state
- » The White House wants a single national standard for artificial intelligence

TRUMP HAS ROUTINELY TRIED TO STAMP OUT STATE-LEVEL AI POLICIES

The White House wants a single national standard for artificial intelligence, arguing that a patchwork of excessive regulation could handicap American innovation in a global competition with China.

But with no progress in Congress, it has been state lawmakers struggling to address concerns about a technology that is poised to reshape the

economy. In Florida, Republican Gov Ron DeSantis added the issue to a special legislative session that he is convening later this month.

Democratic-controlled New York last year required major AI developers to report dangerous incidents to the state. All told, there are more than 1,000 state legislative proposals addressing AI, a reflection of the uneasiness that has

seeped through the country.

“None of us are really sure,” said Brett Young, a structural engineer who attended the backyard event with Fiefa. “Is this something we should be scared about, or is it no so big a deal and it'll enhance our lives?” Trump has routinely tried to stamp out state-level AI policies, and he issued an executive order that included legal threats and funding penalties to deter new regulations.

The White House recently released a framework for potential congressional legislation that calls for preempting state laws considered “too burdensome” but would allow some rights to protect children and copyright material. None of these steps has eased the number of proposals in state capitals.

Popular ideas include forcing chatbots to remind users they are not human and barring the use of AI to make nonconsensual pornography, which includes replacing or removing clothing from photos that are posted online.

‘India’s banking sector credit likely to grow at 11-13% during Jan-June’

While AI is perceived as most disruptive development likely to reshape banking ops, cybersecurity risk is seen as most pressing challenge

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India’s banking sector remains resilient in the backdrop of heightened geo-political uncertainties, with a majority of bankers anticipating a non-food credit growth of 11-13 per cent during January-June 2026, according to the FICCI-IBA Bankers’ Survey unveiled on Sunday.

The outlook is supported by improving balance sheets, steady economic activity, sustained demand across multiple segments of the economy with robust retail and SME credit momentum, and early signs of revival in private capital expenditure.

In contrast, industrial credit growth is expected to expand at a more measured pace, reflecting a gradual recovery rather than a sharp acceleration.

The outlook suggests steady investment activity led by infrastructure development, manufacturing-linked sectors, and government-led capital expenditure.

Term loan demand is expected to be largely driven by infrastructure, real estate, auto and auto components, pharmaceuticals, and emerging sectors such as data centres and defence-related industries.



The outlook is supported by robust retail and SME credit momentum, and early signs of revival in private capital expenditure

Most respondents expect the current monetary policy stance to remain broadly stable in the coming months, indicating a view that the existing policy framework remains appropriately calibrated to balance growth and inflation considerations, FICCI stated.

While Artificial Intelligence is perceived as the most disruptive development likely to reshape banking operations, cybersecurity risk is seen as

Highlights

» In contrast, industrial credit growth is expected to expand at a more measured pace, reflecting a gradual recovery rather than a sharp acceleration

» Outlook suggests steady investment activity led by infra development, manufacturing-linked sectors and govt-led capital expenditure

» Foreign banks predominantly expect 11-13% growth, with a smaller proportion indicating 7-9% growth

A further 29 per cent anticipate growth above 13 per cent, while 17 per cent expect growth in the 9-11 per cent range.

“Only 8 per cent of respondents foresee growth below 9 per cent, evenly split between the 5-7 per cent and 7-9 per cent categories,” noted the survey.

Foreign banks predominantly expect growth in the 11-13 per cent range, with a smaller proportion indicating 7-9 per cent growth.

This reflects moderate optimism, largely shaped by global liquidity conditions, capital allocation priorities, and selective participation in domestic corporate credit markets.

The twenty-first round of the FICCI-IBA Bankers’ Survey captures industry sentiment for the outlook period January to June 2026.

A total of 24 lenders, comprising public sector banks, private sector banks, foreign banks, small finance banks, and cooperative banks, participated in this round. The survey was conducted in January-February, 2026.

Expectations regarding overall credit expansion remain positive, with banks anticipating continued momentum in non-food credit, FICCI stated.

Public sector banks appear particularly confident in the outlook, reflecting improved asset quality, stronger capital positions, and increasing traction in corporate lending.

Sectorally, credit demand from services and retail segments is expected to remain a key driver of overall lending growth.

The services sector outlook reflects strong expectations of expansion, supported by activity in real estate, financial services, logistics, and tourism-related industries. Retail lending is also projected to remain robust, reinforcing its role as a central pillar of banking sector growth.

SME credit demand is expected to remain particularly strong, with respondents expressing high confidence in continued expansion in this segment. This reflects improving business activity among smaller enterprises, increased formalisation of credit channels, and continued policy emphasis on supporting MSME growth.

Sectors such as textiles, automobiles, pharmaceuticals, engineering goods, and food processing are expected to drive industrial working capital borrowing, it added.

Centre may hike FDI limit in pension sector to around 100%

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government may hike the foreign direct investment (FDI) limit in the pension sector to up to 100 per cent and a Bill in this regard is expected in the next Parliament session, according to sources.

This would align with the insurance sector where up to 100 per cent FDI is permitted.

Last year, Parliament approved a Bill to increase the FDI limit in the insurance sector from 74 per cent to 100 per cent.

Prior amendments of the Insurance Act, 1938 was done in 2015 following which the FDI ceiling increased from 49 per cent to 74 per cent.

Amendment to Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) Act, 2013 seeking to raise the FDI limit in the pension sector may come in the Monsoon Session or Winter Session depending on various approvals, sources said. Currently, the FDI in pension fund is capped at 49 per cent.

Besides, sources said the amendment Bill may contain separation of NPS Trust from the PFRDA.

The powers, functions and duties of the NPS Trust, which are currently laid down under the PFRDA (National Pension System Trust) Regulations 2015, may come under a charitable trust or the Companies



Last year, Parliament cleared a Bill to hike the FDI limit in the insurance sector from 74 per cent to 100 per cent

Act, they said.

The intent behind this is to keep NPS Trust separate from the pension regulator and managed competent board of 15 members. Out of this, the majority of members are likely to be from the government as they, including states, are the biggest contributor to the corpus.

The PFRDA was established for promoting and ensuring the orderly growth of the pension sector with sufficient powers over pension funds, the central recordkeeping agency and other intermediaries. It also safeguards the interest of members.

The National Pension System (NPS) was introduced by the Government of India

Key Points

» Prior amendments of the Insurance Act, 1938 was done in 2015 following which the FDI ceiling hiked from 49% to 74%

» Currently, the foreign direct investment (FDI) in pension fund is capped at 49 per cent

» Besides, sources said the amendment Bill may contain separation of NPS Trust from the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority

to replace the defined benefit pension system.

NPS was made mandatory for all new recruits to the central government service from January 1, 2004, (except the armed forces in the first stage) and has also been rolled out for all citizens with effect from May 1, 2009, on voluntary basis.

The government had made a conscious move to shift from the defined benefit, pay-as-you-go pension scheme to defined contribution pension scheme, NPS, due to rising and unsustainable pension bill.

The transition aimed at freeing the limited resources of the government for more productive and socio-economic sectoral development.

Developments in US-Iran conflict, oil prices and Q4 earnings to drive markets this week: Analysts

NEW DELHI: Stock markets would likely track developments in the US-Iran conflict, crude oil prices and quarterly earnings from corporates for further direction this week, analysts said. Besides, trading activity of foreign investors would also influence trading in the markets, they noted.

“Geopolitical developments in the US-Iran conflict will remain a key monitorable, given their direct impact on crude oil prices and global risk sentiment,” Ajit Mishra, SVP, Research, Religare Broking Ltd, said.

Meanwhile, the ceasefire between the US and Iran is set to expire on April 22.

On the domestic front, focus will shift to the ongoing Q4 FY26 earnings season, he said. “Market participants will initially react to results from



banking heavyweights such as HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank. Subsequently, several key companies, including HCL Technologies, Infosys, Tech Mahindra, Havells, IndusInd Bank, Shriram Finance, are scheduled to announce their results,” Mishra added.

The country’s largest private-sector lender, HDFC Bank, on Saturday reported an 8.04 per cent jump in March quarter consolidated net profit to Rs 20,350.76 crore, but flagged near-term risks from the West Asia conflict for a segment of

small-business borrowers.

ICICI Bank on Saturday reported a 9.28 per cent rise in consolidated net profit to Rs 14,755 crore for the March quarter, helped by a nearly 90 per cent drop in provisioning.

Santosh Meena, Head of Research at Swastika Investment Ltd, said, “The primary driver for the coming week will be the deluge of Q4 earnings reports, alongside a keen focus on US macro data and ongoing geopolitical shifts.”

Last week, the BSE benchmark Sensex jumped 943.29 points, or 1.21 per cent, and the NSE Nifty climbed 302.95 points or 1.25 per cent.

“Investor attention will be focused on the trajectory of US-Iran negotiations, with greater emphasis on signs of a durable resolution rather than short-term headlines, given

the implications for global risk assets, capital flows and crude oil prices. “Continued stability or further moderation in crude prices could provide a meaningful tailwind for equities and support the broader macro outlook,” Ponnudi R, CEO — Enrich Money, an online trading and wealth tech firm, said.

After the US and Israel launched an attack on Iran on February 28, Tehran largely halted traffic through the Strait of Hormuz that carries one-fifth of global oil supplies. Following Tehran’s announcement on Friday that it has opened the waterway for commercial traffic, several commercial vessels tried to cross it. However, Tehran on Saturday said it has again closed the waterway, alleging that the US violated a certain understanding reached between the two sides. PFI

Mcap of 8 of top-10 cos rises by ₹1.87 lakh cr

NEW DELHI: The combined market valuation of eight of the top-10 most valued firms surged by Rs 1,87,497.45 crore in a holiday-shortened last week, with Bharti Airtel emerging as the biggest gainer, in line with a positive trend in equities.

“Markets ended the truncated week with notable gains, extending their uptrend for the second consecutive week, supported by easing geopolitical tensions and improving risk sentiment. Optimism surrounding a potential US-Iran peace agreement underpinned market confidence, while stable domestic fundamentals further aided momentum,” Ajit Mishra – SVP, Research, Religare Broking Ltd, said.

The market valuation of Bharti Airtel jumped Rs 58,831.52 crore to Rs 11,25,125.21 crore, the most among the top-10 firms.

The valuation of LIC

Market Cap			
Top 10 (BSE)	₹ crore	As on April 17, 2026	Gain/Loss over April 10
RIL		18,47,317.84	▲ 20,231.05
HDFC Bank		12,31,315.53	▼ -16,163.04
Bharti Airtel		11,25,125.21	▲ 58,831.52
SBI		9,97,229.77	▲ 12,599.79
ICICI Bank		9,65,008.67	▲ 18,266.82
TCS		9,34,063.56	▲ 20,731.64
Bajaj Finance		5,65,437.17	▼ -9,769.30
Larsen & Toubro		5,63,314.50	▲ 18,577.91
Infosys		5,34,774.50	▲ 10,650.10
LIC		5,32,691.31	▲ 27,608.62

surged Rs 27,608.62 crore to Rs 5,32,691.31 crore.

TCS added Rs 20,731.64 crore, taking its market capitali-

sation (mcap) to Rs 9,34,063.56 crore. The mcap of Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) rallied by Rs 20,231.05 crore to Rs 18,47,317.84 crore and that of Larsen & Toubro (L&T) climbed Rs 18,577.91 crore to Rs 5,63,314.50 crore.

ICICI Bank’s mcap edged higher by Rs 18,266.82 crore to Rs 9,65,008.67 crore.

The valuation of SBI went up by Rs 12,599.79 crore to Rs 9,97,229.77 crore and that of Infosys went by Rs 10,650.10 crore to Rs 5,34,774.50 crore.

However, mcap of HDFC Bank dropped by Rs 16,163.04 crore to Rs 12,31,315.53 crore. The mcap of Bajaj Finance diminished by Rs 9,769.30 crore to Rs 5,65,437.17 crore.

Reliance Industries Ltd remained the most valued firm followed by HDFC Bank, Bharti Airtel, SBI, ICICI Bank, TCS, Bajaj Finance, Larsen & Toubro, Infosys and LIC. PFI

‘Silver & gold face key test as West Asia tensions, US data set tone’



NEW DELHI: Silver and gold are expected to witness a decisive week ahead as escalating tensions in West Asia and a slate of macro-economic data are likely to determine whether the rally extends or undergoes a correction, analysts said.

Traders will closely monitor crude prices and key US macroeconomic data including retail sales, housing numbers, and consumer sentiments. Provisional manufacturing and services PMI numbers from major economies such as the UK and the US will also remain on investors’ radar, analysts added.

On the MCX, silver futures rose Rs 13,868, or 5.7 per cent, to settle at Rs 2.57 lakh/kg over the past week, and gold gained Rs 1,957, or 1.3 per cent, to close at Rs 1.54 lakh per 10 grams.

In global markets, Comex silver gained \$5.36, or 7 per cent, to close the week at \$81.84/ounce & gold rose \$92.2, or 2 per cent, to \$4,879.6/ounce. PFI

Air India expecting to complete retrofit of 7 more legacy Boeing 787-8 aircraft this year

NEW DELHI: Air India expects to complete retrofitting of seven more legacy Boeing 787-8 planes this year as it upgrades the fleet of these aircraft that is key to the airline’s long-haul operations.

The loss-making carrier, which is in the midst of an ambitious transformation plan, has received the first of its retrofitted legacy Boeing 787-8 plane, which has 250 seats in three class configuration of business, premium economy and economy. The plane landed in the national capital on April 13.

Air India’s Chief Customer Experience Officer Rajesh Dogra on Sunday said the air-



line expects to complete retrofitting of a total of eight legacy Boeing 787-8s this year.

This includes the plane that landed on April 13.

On Sunday, the airline unveiled the retrofitted, twin-aisle B787-8 (VT-ANT) that underwent a nose-to-tail cabin refresh.

According to Dogra, 85 per cent of the legacy Boeing 787-8

planes retrofit is expected to be completed by the end of 2027 and retrofitting of all such aircraft is likely to be over by the first quarter of 2028.

The Tata Group-owned airline has 33 Boeing 787s or Dreamliners in its fleet of over 190 planes.

Apart from the 26 legacy Boeing 787-8s, there are 7 Boeing 787-9s, including 6 from Vistara and the first tailor-made plane that was inducted in January this year.

The retrofit of legacy Boeing 777 planes is expected to start in the second half of 2027, Dogra said.

In a release issued on Sunday, Air India CEO and MD

Campbell Wilson said the retrofit of its first widebody aircraft is a visible symbol of the momentum behind the airline’s transformation.

“With 25 other 787s undergoing this comprehensive refresh, we are rapidly modernising the backbone of our long-haul fleet and raising the bar for customers flying between India and the world,” he said.

The aircraft VT-ANT received comprehensive interior upgrades at Boeing’s Modification Center in Victorville, California and the painting was done at AeroPro, an aircraft paint facility in San Bernardino, California. PFI

ITC bets big on protein-rich foods, eyes fast-growing health segment market

‘With consumer preferences shifting rapidly, ITC expects its health-focused portfolio to play a significant role in driving future growth’

BENGALURU: Diversified conglomerate ITC Ltd is amplifying its play in the protein food segment, as part of its strategy to expand in the fast-growing health and wellness space, its Chief Executive of the Food division and Executive Director Hemant Malik said.

ITC has introduced unique protein-focused products across multiple categories, in which it has leveraged consumer insights, innovation, and traceable sourcing strengths to build a differentiated portfolio in the fast-growing health segment.

With consumer preferences



shifting rapidly, ITC expects its health-focused portfolio to play a significant role in driving future growth, particularly in protein-based foods that address evolving dietary needs, he said.

The focus of the company

CLOSER LOOK

» The focus of the company is to democratise protein products and make them affordable for consumers

» In Aashirvaad, it has introduced high-protein atta, while in Yoga Bar it now has a diversified protein-led portfolio spanning from protein bars, snacks, oats, ready-to-drink shakes, high-protein, etc

is to democratise protein products and make them affordable for consumers.

“Health is one of the fastest-growing segments, and we are closely monitoring the emerging consumer needs in this space,” Malik said.

With its food staples brand Aashirvaad, nutrition brand ‘Right Shift’ and Yoga Bar, a brand which was acquired by the company, ITC is strengthening its protein play with the launch of a diverse range of protein-rich foods.

“We have introduced unique protein-focused products across multiple categories for different consumer cohorts in simple formats that can be easily added to daily meals,” he said, adding, “We will soon be launching high-protein chips, plant-protein shakes and more.”

In Aashirvaad, it has introduced high-protein atta, while in Yoga Bar it now has a diversified protein-led portfolio spanning from protein bars, snacks, oats, ready-to-drink shakes, high-protein, etc.

Besides, it has also extended its brand Sunfeast, in the pro-

tein segment, where it has fortified Breakfast Smoothie, a ready-to-drink beverage with 6 grams of protein, the amount which is found in one boiled egg.

Underlining the importance of protein in daily diets, Malik said, unlike fat and carbohydrates, the body lacks a storage mechanism for protein.

“Therefore, it is imperative that every meal is protein-rich to maintain muscle mass and repair tissues,” he said. The company is witnessing encouraging consumer response to its ‘Better-for-you’ products that combine science-backed nutri-

tion with taste and quality.

“We expect to see a growing contribution from this segment, including from our protein range, going forward,” he added. According to Malik, in line with emerging consumer trends, health and wellness have been a key focus area at ITC.

Now the thrust of ITC is on “democratising nutrition” for Indian consumers, with the help of its R&D capabilities and its institutional strengths to develop an innovative product portfolio across categories to deliver healthier value-added food offerings. PFI

RINKU, ANUKUL SCRIPT DRAMATIC TURNAROUND

KKR end winless run with four-wicket win over RR

KOLKATA: Vice-captain Rinku Singh lived up to expectations with a composed unbeaten 53 as Kolkata Knight Riders survived anxious moments to script their first win of IPL 2026 with a four-wicket victory over Rajasthan Royals, here on Sunday.

Courtesy Rinku and Anukul Roy, the target was achieved with two balls to spare and the win took them to ninth spot in the 10-team table.

Wily Varun Chakravarthy (3/14) returned to his best, showing perfect chemistry with veteran Sunil Narine (2/26) as KKR rediscovered their spin magic at Eden Gardens to restrict RR to an under-par 155/9. Rookie pacer Kartik Tyagi (3/22) also shone at the death with important wickets.

The bowlers had done half the job for KKR in pursuit of their maiden victory after six matches, and it was up to the batters to finish the task.

But what followed was another familiar batting horror from a line-up that has struggled for consistency this season.

Reeling at 85/6 in 13.3 overs, KKR needed 69 runs from the last six overs, with RR's bowlers tightening the screws and Rinku alongside Anukul Roy appearing to be the last recognised pair.

Then came a moment of fortune as Rinku was dropped on eight by Nandre Burger -- a sitter that proved to be the turning point.

The KKR vice-captain made full use of the reprieve to change gears, while Roy played the perfect supporting role as the duo stitched a match-winning 76-run seventh-wicket stand off just 37 balls to seal KKR's first win of the season.

The much-awaited victory came after a six-match winless run, taking KKR to three points at the halfway stage. For RR, it was a second successive defeat, with their middle-order concerns persisting, especially with skipper Riyan Parag enduring a lean run.

The win will bring much-



Kolkata Knight Riders' Rinku Singh, (second left) exchanges a handshake with Rajasthan Royals' captain Riyan Parag, (left) after winning IPL match, at Eden Gardens in Kolkata on Sunday

6

The bowlers had done half the job for KKR in pursuit of their victory after six matches, and it was up to the batters to finish the task

needed relief for KKR, who had lost from winning positions in recent games. It took them 22 days to finally break the jinx.

On a day when skipper Ajinkya Rahane failed again, registering a second successive duck, it was Rinku who led from the front with 53 not out off 34 balls (5x4, 2x6). Roy complemented him well with 29 not out off 16 balls (1x4, 2x6).

Rinku shifted momentum with a slog-sweep six off Ravi Bishnoi in the 16th over, while Roy matched him with a six in

an over that yielded 19 runs. Rinku then took on RR's best bowler Jofra Archer with two boundaries, and Roy showed great composure by striking a six off him in the penultimate over as KKR were left needing just 11 runs in the final over.

RR will rue falling short by at least 30 runs, undone by the brilliance of Chakravarthy, Narine and Tyagi.

However, they had a perfect start while defending 155. The fiery pace duo of Archer and Burger reduced KKR to 5/2 in 1.2 overs.

Archer struck with the very first ball, rattling Tim Seifert's stumps with a sharp incoming delivery. Rahane followed soon after, edging behind to depart for a duck.

Cameron Green, who had impressed with a 79 in the previous match, counter-attacked with three consecutive boundaries and a six to revive KKR, taking them to 31/2 in four overs. But a smart spell from Bishnoi, combined with a moment of brilliance from wicketkeeper Dhruv Jurel, cut short Green's innings at 27 (13). Thereafter, experienced

campaigner Ravindra Jadeja applied further pressure with his tight lines and turn, dismissing Angkrish Raghuvanshi (10) and Rovman Powell (23) to leave KKR struggling at 70/5 in 10.1 overs.

But just when the chase seemed to be slipping away, Rinku and Roy turned the game on its head with a partnership full of composure and belief.

Earlier RR raced to 63 for no loss in the power play after electing to bat.

Skipper Ajinkya Rahane appeared overly defensive with his approach, delaying the introduction of spin as the Rajasthan openers -- Yas-hasvi Jaiswal and young Vaibhav Sooryavanshi -- clocking at over 10 an over against the innocuous KKR pace attack.

But when they were inserted, the much-anticipated match-up between Sooryavanshi and the experienced spin duo lived up to the expectations.

The 15-year-old struck Narine for a second ball six, but the veteran responded with five dot balls in his first over.

This knock was important for my confidence: KKR VC Rinku

KOLKATA: "There was intensity, but no hesitation," said Rinku Singh after delivering a timely, confidence-boosting unbeaten 53 under pressure to fire Kolkata Knight Riders to their first win of the season against Rajasthan Royals in a tense IPL clash here Sunday.

Walking in with the chase hanging in the balance, Rinku combined composure with controlled aggression to see the game through, even as emotions ran high. "Sometimes it happens like that when a few things don't go your way, so you feel that intensity. But it wasn't like I was hesitating or unsure about playing my shots. My mindset was to take the game till the end," the KKR vice-captain said in the post-match presentation.

The left-hander, who had been searching for a substantial knock this season, made full use of an early reprieve, turning the tide decisively in KKR's favour. "That's what happens sometimes. The mind doesn't work properly and you end up playing such shots. But thankfully, luck was on my side and we eventually won the match," he said.

AGENCIES

Super Priyansh puts up a show as Punjab slay LSG

MULLANPUR: Priyansh Arya, one of the country's most talked about T20 batting talent alongside Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, smashed his way to a magnificent 93 as Punjab Kings clinically demolished Lucknow Super Kings by 54 runs in an IPL match here on Sunday.

The 24-year-old Delhi man, whose knock came off just 37 balls, joined hands with Cooper Connolly, the most talked about next-gen batting star in Australia, who also oozed class in his 45-ball-87 as Punjab Kings posted an insurmountable 254 for 7 in 20 overs.

The duo added an astounding 182 runs off just 80 balls with 16 sixes (9 from Priyansh and 7 from Connolly) and 12 fours shared between them.

In reply, Lucknow Super Giants despite a reasonably good Powerplay that fetched 61 runs were never in contention as they finished on 200 for five in 20 overs.

The likes of skipper Rishabh Pant (43 off 23 balls) and Mitchell Marsh (40 off 28 balls) tried but their intent and execution paled in comparison to the six-hitting exhibition of Priyansh and Connolly.

Vyshak Vijaykumar (1/30 in 4 overs) was brilliant with his pace-on and pace-off variations that stopped both Marsh and Pant in their tracks.

Once both were gone, wrapping up the match was a mere formality for Shreyas Iyer's men, itching to go one better than their previous runners-up finish in 2025.

When Punjab Kings batted, the Powerplay score of 63 for one was good, they were even better in the middle phase between overs 7th and 11th in which 66 runs came.

Priyansh, the beefy south-paw, just stood and delivered with minimal footwork and maximum bat speed as balls flew thick and fast.

The full balls were muscled



Punjab Kings' Vijaykumar Vyshak, right, and Arshdeep Singh celebrate the wicket of LSG's Ayush Badoni, in New Chandigarh on Sunday

PTI

down the ground or over extra cover.

The short and wide deliveries were slashed or ramped while bouncers on the shoulders were either pulled or hooked without an iota of expression on his face.

It seemed like a regular job for the man, who also learnt ropes from Gautam Gambhir's childhood coach Sanjay Bhardwaj.

Connolly was in a different mould as his lofted sixes over extra cover and front-foot pull-shots into the deep mid-wicket stands would have even made his franchise coach Ricky Ponting proud.

AGENCIES

Floundering Mumbai Indians look for answers against confident Gujarat Titans

AHMEDABAD: An embattled Mumbai Indians side will be desperate to arrest its slide when it takes on a confident Gujarat Titans outfit, which is eager to extend its winning run, in the Indian Premier League here on Monday.

The two teams enter the fixture having endured contrasting fortunes in recent weeks. The Titans, after opening their campaign with back-to-back defeats, have rediscovered their rhythm with three successive wins which has placed them sixth on the table.

Mumbai, in stark contrast, began with a rare opening-game victory but have since unravelled, suffering four defeats on the bounce and the margin of their losses have been huge, leaving them languishing at ninth.

For the five-time champions, it has been a season where little has clicked. Their campaign has been undermined by

TEAMS:
Gujarat Titans: Shubman Gill (c), Anuj Rawat, Jos Buttler, Kumar Kushagra, Glenn Phillips, Rashid Khan, Manav Suthar, Nishant Sindhu, Rahul Tewatia, Washington Sundar, Gurnoor Brar, Arshad Khan, Mohammed Siraj, Prasidh Krishna, Kagiso Rabada, Ravishrinivasan Sai Kishore, Ishant Sharma, Ashok Sharma, Jason Holder, Tom Banton, Luke Wood, Sai Sudharsan, M Shahrukh Khan, Jayant Yadav, Kulwant Khejroliya.
Mumbai Indians: Hardik Pandya (c), Quinton de Kock (wk), Danish Malewar, Robin Minz (wk), Ryan Rickelton (wk), Sherfane Rutherford, Rohit Sharma, Suryakumar Yadav, Tilak Varma, Atharva Ankolekar, Raj Bawa, Corbin Bosch, Will Jacks, Mayank Rawat, Naman Dhir, Mitchell Santner, Shardul Thakur, Ashwani Kumar, Trent Boult, Jasprit Bumrah, Deepak Chahar, AM Ghazanfar, Mayank Markande, Mohd Izhar, Raghu Sharma.

a combination of timid power-play returns, inconsistent middle-order output, and a bowling attack that has lacked penetration. Much of the spotlight has been on Suryakumar Yadav and Tilak Varma, the fulcrum of MI's middle order.

While Suryakumar has shown flashes of brilliance, including a half-century, he has struggled for consistency. Tilak, meanwhile, has been woefully out of form, managing just 43 runs in five innings.

AGENCIES

2nd women's T20I: Wolvaardt, Luus fifties help SA script 8-wicket win over India

DURBAN: Laura Wolvaardt made a free-flowing 54 and Sune Luus complemented her skipper with a well-composed 57 as South Africa crushed India by eight wickets in the second women's T20I here on Sunday. The match's script was written in clear letters once SA bowlers bundled out India for a below-par 147, and it was

taken into its logical culmination by Wolvaardt and Luus who added 106 runs for the opening alliance in just 12 overs.

The hosts made 148 for two in 17.1 overs. SA now lead the five-match series 2-0. Wolvaardt was quite impressive, making runs more through finding gaps rather

than going for big hits.

However, the SA skipper freed her hands whenever the opportunity presented, like an inside out six over covers off left-arm spinner Sree Charani. Wolvaardt soon reached her fifty, 15th in a stellar T20I career so far, off just 30 balls. At the other end, Luus was more patient,

working spinners around for singles and twos with occasional boundaries, such as a maximum off off-spinner Shreyanka Patil.

The Bengaluru cricketer, however, had the last laugh, getting rid of both Wolvaardt and Luus, but the two wickets came too late to alter the course of the match.

AGENCIES

Real Kashmir stun Sreenidi Deccan 2-0

SRINAGAR: Goals from Ahteab Ahmad Dar and Oinam Sanatomba Singh engineered an upset as Real Kashmir FC defeated Sreenidi Deccan FC 2-0 in their IFL match here on Sunday.

The victory provided a major lifeline for the Snow Leopards, who moved up to ninth position to reignite their hopes of avoiding relegation.

Sreenidi Deccan FC, meanwhile, missed the opportunity to go second in the standings, ending the first round with 15 points. Marius Obekop was adjudged the Player of the Match for providing two assists and delivering an outstanding all-round performance.

The match began with intense aerial duels before the visitors established their dominance. Sreenidi controlled possession and threatened early, with keeper Furkan Ahmad Dar with a header from a Chhangte cross in the seventh minute. Real Kashmir FC operated cautiously, primarily relying on set-pieces, including a dangerous free-kick won after Shedrack Charles was fouled by Ajay Chhetri in the 34th minute.

AGENCIES

Robson strike powers Mohun Bagan past NorthEast in rain-hit encounter

The defending champions took the lead inside five minutes

GUWAHATI: Mohun Bagan Super Giant edged North-East United FC 1-0 in a rain-affected contest of the Indian Super League at the Indira Gandhi Athletic Stadium here on Sunday.

The defending champions took the lead inside five minutes through Robson, who arrived late into the box to finish a well-worked move, and then relied on a disciplined defensive display led by Vishal Kaith to see out the result in difficult conditions.

With this victory, Mohun Bagan moved to the top of the table with 20 points from nine matches, opening a two-point lead over Mumbai City FC. NorthEast United FC, meanwhile, remain 12th with seven points from the same number of matches.

The Mariners started brightly and showed intent from the opening exchanges, with Jamie Maclaren making a surging run down the right in the third minute before being denied by a timely interception from the Highlanders right back Robin Yadav.

The breakthrough arrived soon after in the fifth minute



NorthEast United gradually grew into the game

with a fluid attacking move. Liston Colaco initiated the play from the right and found Sahal Abdul Samad, who drove into the box before cutting the ball back into the centre.

Robson timed his run to perfection, meeting the pass with a composed right-footed finish into the top of the net to hand Mohun Bagan an early advantage.

Mohun Bagan continued to dominate possession through the first half, with Jason Cummings, Sahal, and Robinho all testing the NorthEast defence,

but Gurmeet Singh stood firm in goal to keep the margin at one. The heavy rain made conditions increasingly difficult, with the ball skidding unpredictably and both sides struggling to maintain control in the final third.

NorthEast United gradually grew into the game and had their first real opportunity in the 36th minute when Parthib Gogoi was played through, but Vishal Kaith came off his line smartly to narrow the angle and force the effort wide.

AGENCIES

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Narender Kumar, S/o Randhir, R/o H.No. 1264, Cindicate Bank Gali Barwala, Shahbad Dairy, Outer North, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 240/2019, U/s 279/304 A. IPC, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Narender Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Narender Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Narender Kumar** accused of **FIR No. 240/2019, U/s 279/304 A. IPC, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.05.2026**.

By Order - **Ms. Bharti Beniwal**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, North District
DP/5147/ON/2026 Room No. 114, Rohini Courts, Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

REMOVAL OF ENCROACHMENTS & UNAUTHORIZED USE IN STILT FLOORS
Whereas, the Hon'ble Punjab and Haryana High Court has restrained implementation of the Stilt + 4 floor policy for residential plots, and vide order dated 02.04.2026 in CWP (PIL) No. 212 of 2024 titled

"**Sunil Singh Vs State of Haryana & Others**" and connected matters, the operation of instructions dated 02.07.2024 issued by the Additional Chief Secretary to Govt. of Haryana, Town and Country Planning Department, has been stayed.

In view of the above orders, the Department of Town and Country Planning, Govt. of Haryana, vide order dated 16.04.2026, has directed removal of all encroachments on the Right of Way (RoW) of roads, including green areas, lawns, landscaped areas, boundary walls, etc. Further, immediate action has been directed against violators indulging in unauthorized use/occupation/construction in stilt floors of residential plots.

Accordingly, to maintain parity in areas under the jurisdiction of Municipal Corporation Faridabad, all colonizers/developers, plot/floor owners, occupiers, Residents Welfare Associations (RWAs), and other concerned persons are hereby directed to:

- Remove encroachments made on the Right of Way of internal roads of TTP schemes, residential colonies transferred to MCF, rehabilitation scheme, residential schemes developed by MCF and other similar areas under MCF control, including green areas, lawns, landscaped areas, boundary walls, etc., with immediate effect.
- Discontinue unauthorized use/occupation/construction in stilt floors of residential plots immediately and restore stilt floors strictly to the permitted use as per approved building plans.

Failing compliance, necessary action to remove the aforesaid violations/encroachments and restore the Right of Way/buildings in conformity with the approved layout/building plans shall be taken by the undersigned as per provisions of law. Non-compliance shall also invite legal penal action against the offenders.

कार्यालय आरक्षक, नगर निगम फरीदाबाद

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mahendra, S/o Sh. Ram Sharan, R/o H.No. B-2A, Main Gamri Road in Front of Tikona Park, Gamri Extension, Bhajanpura, North East, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 368/2022, U/s 135/150 I.E. Act, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mahendra** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mahendra** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mahendra** accused of **FIR No. 368/2022, U/s 135/150 I.E. Act, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.05.2026**.

By Order - **Sh. Ashish Rastogi**
Additional Sessions Judge-05
East, Room No. 21, 1st Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/5141/NE/2026

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (BUILDING)

PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT SOUTH CIVIL LINE JABALPUR
NIT No.11/2026/Centralized Tender/G/CE(B)/Date 16/04/2026

Online bids for the following works are invited from registered contractors and firms of repute fulfilling registration

S.No.	Tender Portal No.	Name of work	District	Probable Amount Contract (Rs. in lakh)	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (in Rs.)	Cost of Bid Document (in Rs.)	Period of completion (in months i/c Rainy Season)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	2026_PWPIU_501010_1	Construction of 06 Trade ITI Building, 30 seated Boys and 30 seated Girls Hostel and 1'F', 2 'H', 4 'I' Type Quarters at Sihora District Jabalpur. (1st Call)	Jabalpur	1334.45	1000000.00	30000.00	18
2	2026_PWPIU_501022_1	Construction of Boundary Wall with Consertina Coil Fencing at Pt. Ramshankar Pathak Government College Barela District Jabalpur. (1st Call)	Jabalpur	77.97	77970.00	10000.00	6

- All details relating to the Bid document (s) can be viewed and downloaded free of cost from the website: <http://mptenders.gov.in>
- Bid Document (s) can be purchased after making online payment of portal fees through Credit/Debit/Cash Card/Internet Banking.
- The Bid Document (s) can be purchased only online from 9.00 1(time) 17-04-2026 (date) to 18.00(time) 25-04-2026 (date). Other key dates may be seen in Bid Data Sheet.
- Amendment (s) to NIT, if any, shall be published on website only, and not in newspaper.

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (BUILDING) PWD
JABALPUR

G11743/26

"स्वाभाव स्वच्छता, संस्कार स्वच्छता"

Format C-1

(for candidate to publish in Newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal cases
(As per the judgment dated 25thSeptember,2018, of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)

Name and address of candidate: **Subrata Dutta, resident of, Village – Patrasayer, P.O. – Patrasayer, P.S. – Patrasayer, Dist. – Bankura, PIN – 722206, West Bengal.**

Name of political party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS**
(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)

Name of Election: **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL, 2026**

*Name of Constituency: – **254- Onda Assembly Constituency**

I, **Subrata Dutta**, a candidate for the abovementioned election, declares for public information the following details about my criminal antecedents:

A. Pending criminal cases				
Sl No.	Name of Court	Case No. and dated	Status of case(s)	Section(s) of Acts concerned and brief description of offence(s)
1.	Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 1618 of 25 arising out of PS Case No. 276/2025, dated 08/11/2025, Patrasayer Police Station	Charges not framed,	Alleged offences under Sections 126(2)/115(2)/118(1)/117(2)/109/76/ 324(4)/303(2)/351(2)(3)/3(5) of B.N.S, 2023. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means.Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means, attempt to murder, Assault or use of criminal force to woman with intent to disrobe. Punishment for mischief thereby causes loss or damage to the amount of twenty thousand rupees and more but less than one lakh. Punishment for theft, Punishment for Criminal intimidation,Criminal act done by several persons in furtherance of the common intention of all, each of such persons is liable for that act in the same manner as if it were done by him alone.
2	Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 1123 of 17 arising out of PS Case No. 284/2017, dated 19/11/2017, PatrasayerPolice Station	Charges not framed,	Alleged offences under Sections 147/148/149/337/338 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860, and Sections 3/4 of E.S. Act 1908. Punishment for rioting. Punishment for rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Causing hurt by act endangering life or personal safety of others. Causing grievous hurt by act endangering life or personal safety of others. Punishment for causing explosion likely to endanger life or property. Punishment for attempt to cause explosion, or for making or keeping explosive with intent to endanger life or property.
3	Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 496 of 17 arising out of PS Case No. 92/2017, dated 14/05/2017, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed,	Alleged offences under Sections341/323/325/308/379/427/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Punishment for theft. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
4	Learned ACJM Bishnupur,	G.R. Case NO. 475/17, arising out of FIR No. 88/2017, dt. 07.05.2017, Patrasayer police Station	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/324/325/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means, punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt, punishment for criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
5	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 258/17, arising out FIR No. 44/2017, dt. 15.03.2017, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/325/506/308/379 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. And section 25/27 of the Arms Act. Punishment for unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Criminal intimidation. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Punishment for theft. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.
6	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 1177/16, arising out FIR No. 239/2016, dt. 10.12.2016, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/341/323/424/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Dishonest or fraudulent removal or concealment of property. Criminal intimidation.
7	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 1107/16, arising out FIR No. 233/2016, dt. 21.11.2016, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 148/149/341/323/325/308/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. And sections 9(b) I.E act and sections 25 & 27 of the Arms Act. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation. Acquisition, possession or carrying of any prohibited arms or ammunition. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.
8	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 323/16, arising out FIR No. 74/2016, dt. 10.04.2016, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/323/325/326/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Criminal intimidation.
9	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 212/15, arising out FIR No. 65/2015, dt. 14.03.2015, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/506/186/353/332 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for rioting, every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt, punishment for criminal intimidation, obstructing public servant in discharge of public functions, assault or criminal force to deter public servant from discharge of his duty, voluntarily causing hurt to deter public servant from his duty.
10	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 83/15, arising out FIR No. 25/2015, dt. 22.01.2015, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges framed, on 23.09.2024.	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/325/354/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Every member of unlawful assembly is guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more.
11	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 773/14, arising out FIR No. 157/2014, dt. 26.12.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/341/323 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapons. Every member of unlawful assembly is guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt.
12	Learned ACJM, Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 702/14, arising out FIR No. 133/2014, dt. 26.11.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/325/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860 Rioting. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Criminal intimidation.
13	Learned ADJ Bishnupur,	S.C.No.- 07(12) 19, arising out FIR No. 103/2014, dt. 12.10.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 376/306/506/509/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rape. Abetment of suicide. Criminal intimidation. Word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
14	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 616/14, arising out FIR No. 100/2014, dt. 01.10.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/324/354/147/148/149/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.

continue next page

15	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 561/14, arising out FIR No. 90/2014, dt. 12.09.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
16	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 529/14, arising out FIR No. 79/2014, dt. 13.08.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/448/427/323/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. House-trespass. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation.
17	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 508/14, arising out FIR No. 78/2014, dt. 13.08.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/506/143 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Punishment for Unlawful assembly.
18	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 390/14, arising out FIR No. 61/2014, dt. 14.06.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/323/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more.
19	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 772/10, arising out FIR No. 114/2010, dt. 15.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/326/379/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for Theft. Criminal intimidation.
20	Learned ACJM, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 760/10, arising out FIR No. 110/2010, dt. 12.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/323/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
21	Learned ACJM, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 757/10, arising out FIR No. 108/2010, dt. 11.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/186 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b) I.E act & 9 MPO. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Obstructing public servant in discharge of public functions. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Preventive measures for maintenance of public order.
22	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 748/10, arising out FIR No. 105/2010, dt. 07.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/323/324/325/326/379/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for theft. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
23	Learned ACJM Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 696/10, arising out FIR No. 98/2010, dt. 20.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Criminal intimidation.
24	Learned ACJM Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 695/10, arising out FIR No. 97/2010, dt. 13.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/323/324/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b) I.E Act Sections 3(i)(ii) 10 (ii) of SC & ST Act. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Used words, acts or gesture of a sexual nature towards a woman belonging to a schedule caste/ schedule tribe, knowing that she belongs to a schedule caste/schedule tribe.
25	Learned ACJM Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 644/10, arising out FIR No. 92/2010, dt. 03.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/448/324/323/326 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 9(b) of the I.E Act Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for House-trespass. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition.
26	Learned 11th Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur.	N.G.R. Case No. 139/11, arising out NCR No. 268/2010, dt. 02.10.2010, Patrasayer Police Station	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Section 506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for criminal intimidation.
27	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 428/10, arising out FIR No. 58/2010, dt. 15.08.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/324/325/323/326/307/379/ of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b) I.E. Act, Sections 25 & 27 ARMS Act. Punishment for rioting, Rioting, armed with deadly weapon, every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Attempt to murder. Punishment for theft. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.
28	Learned ACJM Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 377/10, arising out FIR No. 47/2010, dt. 28.07.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/323/325/364/365 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for rioting, rioting while armed with deadly weapons, unlawful assembly with common object, voluntarily causing hurt, voluntarily causing grievous hurt, and kidnapping/abduction with intent to murder or to secretly and wrongfully confine a person.
29	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 376/10, arising out FIR No. 46/2010, dt. 28.07.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/186/353/332/224/225/333/379/427/506/307 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting, rioting armed with a deadly weapon; every member of an unlawful assembly guilty of an offence committed in prosecution of the common object; obstructing a public servant in discharge of public functions; assault or criminal force to deter a public servant from discharge of duty; voluntarily causing hurt to deter a public servant from duty; voluntarily causing grievous hurt to deter a public servant from duty; resistance or obstruction by a person to his lawful apprehension; resistance or obstruction to the lawful apprehension of another person; theft; mischief causing damage; criminal intimidation; and attempt to murder.
30	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 220/10, arising out FIR No. 34/2010, dt. 04.05.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges Not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/452/323/354/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. House-trespass after preparation for hurt, assault or wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation.
31	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 216/10, arising out FIR No. 32/2010, dt. 28.04.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges Not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/323/448/379/363 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. House-trespass. Punishment for theft. Kidnapping.
32	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 163/10, arising out FIR No. 21/2010, dt. 04.04.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges framed on, 02.05.2015	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/323/341/354/379/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Punishment for theft. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation.
B.	Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences			
Sl. No	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed	Maximum Punishment Imposed	
1.	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.



Format C-2

(For political party to publish in website, newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal antecedents of candidates set up by the party
(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018 of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)
Name of political party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**
(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)
Name of Election: **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL, 2026**
Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**

1	2	3	4		5		
Sl No.	Name of constituency	Name of candi-date	(A) Pending criminal cases		(B) Details about cases of con-viction for criminal offences		
			Name of Court, case No. & status of the case(s)	Sections of the Acts concerned & brief description of offence(s)	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & pun-ishment imposed	Maxi-mum Punish-ment Imposed
1	254- Onda Assembly Constitu-ency	Subrata Dutta	a. Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnu-pur, G.R. Case No. 1618 of 25 arising out of PS Case No. 276/2025, dated 08/11/2025, Patrasayer Police Station, Charges not framed.	a. Alleged offences under Sections 126(2)/115(2)/118(1)/117(2)/109/76/324(4)/303(2)/351(2)(3)/3(5) of B.N.S, 2023. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt by danger-ous weapons or means. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means, Attempt to murder, Assault or use of criminal force to woman with intent to disrobe. Punishment for mischief thereby causes loss or damage to the amount of twenty thousand rupees and more but less than one lakh. Punishment for theft, Pun-ishment for Criminal intimidation.	a.N/A	a.N/A	a.N/A
			b.Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnu-pur, G.R. Case No. 1123 of 17 arising out of PS Case No. 284/2017, dated 19/11/2017, Patrasayer Police Station, Charges not framed.	b. Alleged offences under Sections 147/148/149/337/338 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860, and Sections 3/4 of E.S. Act 1908. Punishment for rioting. Punishment for rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every mem-ber of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Causing hurt by act endangering life or personal safety of others. Causing grievous hurt by act endangering life or personal safety of others.	b. N/A	b. N/A	b. N/A
			c. Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur, G.R. Case No. 496 of 17 (arising out of PS Case No. 92/2017, dated 14/05/2017, Patrasayer Police Station) Charges not framed	c. Alleged offences under Sections 341/323/325/308/379/427/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punish-ment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Pun-ishment for theft. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	c. N/A	c. N/A	c. N/A
			d. Learned ACJM Bishnupur, G.R. Case NO. 475/17, aris-ing out of FIR No. 88/2017, dt. 07.05.2017, Patrasayer police Station Charges not framed	d. Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/324/325/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means, punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt, punishment for criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	d.N/A	d.N/A	d.N/A
			e. Learned 3rd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 258/17, aris-ing out FIR No. 44/2017, dt. 15.03.2017, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	e. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/325/506/308/379 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. And section 25/27 of the Arms Act. Punishment for Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Criminal intimidation. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Punishment for theft. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.	e.N/A	e.N/A	e.N/A
			f. Learned 2nd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 1177/16, aris-ing out FIR No. 239/2016, dt. 10.12.2016, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	f. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/341/323/424/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Dishonest or fraudulent removal or concealment of property. Criminal intimidation.	f.N/A	f.N/A	f.N/A
			g. Learned 2nd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 1107/16, aris-ing out FIR No. 233/2016, dt. 21.11.2016, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	g. Alleged Offences under Sections – 148/149/341/323/325/308/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. And sections 9(b) I.E act and sections 25 & 27 of the Arms Act. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punish-ment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation. Acquisition, possession or carrying of any prohibited arms or ammunition. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.	g.N/A	g.N/A	g.N/A
			h. Learned 2nd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 323/16, aris-ing out FIR No. 74/2016, dt. 10.04.2016, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	h. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/323/325/326506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Criminal intimidation.	h.N/A	h.N/A	h.N/A
			i. Learned 3rd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 212/15, aris-ing out FIR No. 65/2015, dt. 14.03.2015, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	i. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/506/186/353/332 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for rioting, every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt, punishment for crimi-nal intimidation, obstructing public servant in discharge of public functions, assault or criminal force to deter public servant from discharge of his duty, voluntarily causing hurt to deter public servant from his duty.	i.N/A	i.N/A	i.N/A
			j. Learned 3rd Judicial Mag-istrate, Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 83/15, arising out FIR No. 25/2015, dt. 22.01.2015, Patra-sayer Police Station. Charges framed, on 23.09.2024.	j. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/325/354/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Every member of unlawful assembly is guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more.	j.N/A	j.N/A	j.N/A
			k. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 773/14, arising out FIR No. 157/2014, dt. 26.12.2014, Patrasayer Police Sta-tion. Charges	k. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/341/323 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapons. Every member of unlawful assembly is guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt.	k.N/A	k.N/A	k.N/A
			l. Learned ACJM, Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 702/14, aris-ing out FIR No. 133/2014, dt. 26.11.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	l. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/325/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860 Rioting. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Criminal intimidation.	l.N/A	l.N/A	l.N/A
			m. Learned ADJ Bishnupur, S.C.No.- 07(12) 19, aris-ing out FIR No. 103/2014, dt. 12.10.2014, Patrasayer Police Station Charged not framed	m. Alleged Offences under Sections – 376/306/506/509/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rape. Abetment of suicide. Criminal intimidation. Word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	m.N/A	m.N/A	m.N/A
			n. Learned 2nd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 616/14, aris-ing out FIR No. 100/2014, dt. 01.10.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	n. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/324/354/147/148/149/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily caus-ing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	n.N/A	n.N/A	n.N/A
			o. Learned 3rd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 561/14, aris-ing out FIR No. 90/2014, dt. 12.09.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	o. Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	o.N/A	o.N/A	o.N/A

continue next page

			p. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 529/14, arising out FIR No. 79/2014, dt. 13.08.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	p. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/448/427/323/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for House-trespass. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation.	p.N/A	p.N/A	p.N/A
			q. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 508/14, arising out FIR No. 78/2014, dt. 13.08.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	q. Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/506/143 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Punishment for Unlawful assembly.	q.N/A	q.N/A	q.N/A
			r. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 390/14, arising out FIR No. 61/2014, dt. 14.06.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	r. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/323/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more.	r.N/A	r.N/A	r.N/A
			s. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 772/10, arising out FIR No. 114/2010, dt. 15.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	s. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/326/379/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for theft. Criminal intimidation.	s.N/A	s.N/A	s.N/A
			t. Learned ACJM, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 760/10, arising out FIR No. 110/2010, dt. 12.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	t. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/323/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	t.N/A	t.N/A	t.N/A
			u. Learned ACJM, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 757/10, arising out FIR No. 108/2010, dt. 11.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	u. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/186 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b) I.E act & 9 MPO. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapons. Every member of unlawful assembly is guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Obstructing public servant in discharge of public functions. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Preventive measures for maintenance of public order.	u.N/A	u.N/A	u.N/A
			v. Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur, G.R. Case No. 748/10, arising out FIR No. 105/2010, dt. 07.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	v. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/323/324/325/326/379/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for theft. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	v.N/A	v.N/A	v.N/A
			w. Learned ACJM Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 696/10, arising out FIR No. 98/2010, dt. 20.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	w. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Criminal intimidation.	w.N/A	w.N/A	w.N/A
			x. Learned ACJM Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 695/10, arising out FIR No. 97/2010, dt. 13.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	x. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/323/324/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b) I.E Act Sections 3(i)(ii) 10 (ii) of SC & ST Act. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Used words, acts or gesture of a sexual nature towards a woman belonging to a schedule caste/ schedule tribe, knowing that she belongs to a schedule caste/schedule tribe.	x.N/A	x.N/A	x.N/A
			y. Learned ACJM Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 644/10, arising out FIR No. 92/2010, dt. 03.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	y. Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/448/324/323/326 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 9(b) of the I.E Act Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for House-trespass. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition.	y.N/A	y.N/A	y.N/A
			z. Learned 11th Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. N.G.R. Case No. 139/11, arising out NCR No. 268/2010, dt. 02.10.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	z. Alleged Offenceunder Section 506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for criminal intimidation.	z.N/A	z.N/A	z.N/A
			aa.Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 428/10, arising out FIR No. 58/2010, dt. 15.08.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	aa.Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/324/325/323/326/307/379/ of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b)I.E. Act, Sections 25 & 27 ARMS Act. Punishment for rioting, Rioting, armed with deadly weapon, every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Attempt to murder. Punishment for theft. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.	aa.N/A	aa.N/A	aa.N/A
			ab. Learned ACJM Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 377/10, arising out FIR No. 47/2010, dt. 28.07.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	ab. Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/323/325/364/365 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for rioting, rioting while armed with deadly weapons, unlawful assembly with common object, voluntarily causing hurt, voluntarily causing grievous hurt, and kidnapping/ abduction with intent to murder or to secretly and wrongfully confine a person.	ab.N/A	ab.N/A	ab.N/A
			ac. Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 376/10, arising out FIR No. 46/2010, dt. 28.07.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	ac. Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/186/353/332/224/225/333/379/427/506/3 07 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. rioting; rioting armed with a deadly weapon; every member of an unlawful assembly guilty of an offence committed in prosecution of the common object; obstructing a public servant in discharge of public functions; assault or criminal force to deter a public servant from discharge of duty; voluntarily causing hurt to deter a public servant from duty; voluntarily causing grievous hurt to deter a public servant from duty; resistance or obstruction by a person to his lawful apprehension; resistance or obstruction to the lawful apprehension of another person; theft; mischief causing damage; criminal intimidation; and attempt to murder.	ac.N/A	ac.N/A	ac.N/A
			ad. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 220/10, arising out FIR No. 34/2010, dt. 04.05.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	ad.Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/452/323/354/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. House-trespass after preparation for hurt, assault or wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation.	ad.N/A	ad.N/A	ad.N/A
			ae. Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 216/10, arising out FIR No. 32/2010, dt. 28.04.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/323/448/379/363 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. House-trespass. Punishment for theft. Kidnapping.	ae.N/A	ae.N/A	ae.N/A
			af. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 163/10, arising out FIR No. 21/2010, dt. 04.04.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges framed no 02.05.2015.	af.Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/323/341/354/379/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Punishment for theft. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation.	af.N/A	af.N/A	af.N/A

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.





'MAMMA MIA 3 WILL HAPPEN'

Amanda Seyfried is sure her starrer film will return with the third instalment

She previously said she will 'keep campaigning for it until she is blue in the face'



LONDON: Hollywood actress Amanda Seyfried is sure her starrer 'Mamma Mia' will return with the third instalment. "It's just interesting that... It'll happen. I know it's going to happen. If there's a need, you know," she told the entertainment magazine 'People'. The first film was released in 2008, featuring Seyfried alongside Meryl Streep. It was directed by Phyllida Lloyd and it revolved around a young bride-to-be, Sophie (Seyfried), who invites three men to her upcoming wedding, with the possibility that any of them could be her real father. The sequel, titled 'Mamma Mia! Here We Go Again' was directed by Ol Parker and released in 2018. It fol-

lowed a pregnant Sophie reopening her late mother Donna's hotel while flashing back to how young Donna (Lily James) arrived in Greece and met Sophie's three potential fathers. The actress previously talked about the film and said she will 'keep campaigning for it until she is blue in the face'. Both films went on to have good box office runs, with the first film collecting over 610 million US dollars at the global box office and the second film grossing over 400 million US dollars. The collection of both films grossed over 1 billion US dollars at the global box office. PTI

3RD HIGHEST-GROSSING INDIAN FILM WORLDWIDE 'Dhurandhar 2' dethrones 'Pushpa 2' at Indian box office



Aditya Dhar's spy thriller 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge', starring Ranveer Singh, has slowed down at the Indian box office. On Saturday (Day 31), the film earned Rs 4.65 crore. While that was a decent hike after earning Rs 2.70 crore on Friday (day 30), it's quite a decline from the sequel's Rs 13.50 crore last Saturday. That happened thanks to a new, formidable competitor in Priyadarshan-Akshay Kumar's horror comedy 'Bhooth Bangla', which earned over Rs 12 crore on Fri-

'Dhurandhar 2' has so far earned over Rs 420 crore overseas

day and Rs 19 crore on Saturday. As per 'Sacnilk', the total box office collection of 'Dhurandhar 2' in India after over a month now stands at Rs 1329.31 crore gross and Rs 1110.47 crore net. The sequel is already the highest-

grossing Hindi film ever at the domestic box office, surpassing its first part, which released this past December and went on to earn around Rs 890 crore in India. As 'Dhurandhar 2' enters its fifth week at the domestic box office, its collections are likely to go down, given fresh competition and its current trajectory. Its week 4 collection, Rs 54.70 crore, was around half of its week 3 collection, Rs 110.60 crore. That, in turn, was down by more than half of its week 2 collection, Rs 263.65 crore, almost one-third of the film's opening week collection of Rs 674.17 crore. 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge' has so far earned over Rs 420 crore overseas, which takes its worldwide box office collection to Rs 1748.91 crore.



Vijay Varma talks about working with Sunny Deol in 'Antony'

MUMBAI: Vijay Varma said he is excited about sharing screen space with Sunny Deol in the upcoming film 'Antony' and called him the 'most gentle and loving icon'. The actors are set to feature in the upcoming action thriller, which is directed by Balaji Ganesh and produced by 'Excel Entertainment' with A R Murugadoss. The film will have Deol essay the high-octane role with Varma playing the antagonist. "I know closely how it feels to get a 'dhai kilo ka haath'. He is the sweetest, most gentle, humble and very loving icon that we have," Varma told PTI in an interview. PTI

Deepika & Ranveer ANNOUNCE SECOND PREGNANCY

NEW DELHI: Ranveer Singh and Deepika Padukone announced they are expecting their second child. The couple shared a collaborative post on their respective 'Instagram' handles, which featured their first daughter, Dua, holding a positive pregnancy test kit. Several celebrities went on to congratulate the couple in the comment section, including Kiara Advani and Priyanka Chopra Jonas. Singh and Padukone tied the knot in November 2018 in Italy. They welcomed their first child on September 8, 2024. Singh's latest work, Aditya Dhar's directorial 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge', which was released in March, has earned over Rs 1500 crore at the global box office. The film is a sequel to Dhar's 2025 directorial 'Dhurandhar', which featured the actor in the role of Hamza Ali Mazari, an



undercover Research and Analysis Wing (R&AW) operative. Padukone is set to feature alongside Shah Rukh Khan in 'King'. The film is directed by Siddharth Anand and will be released in December. It also reunites Padukone with Khan and Anand, with whom she has worked in 'Pathaan'. The film was released in 2023. PTI



There is a place for AI in Hollywood: Sandra Bullock

LOS ANGELES: Oscar-winning actress Sandra Bullock thinks Hollywood should be more open to using artificial intelligence in a 'really constructive and creative' manner and is sure there is a place for such technology in the industry. Reacting to fans' AI-generated trailers of her upcoming film 'Practical Magic 2', Bullock said the industry needs to learn how to use the technology as its friend. "Well, there could be worse with my image. Sorry... But it's here. We have to observe it. We have to understand it. We have to lean into it. We have to use it in a really constructive and creative way, make it our friend," she said at the CNBC Changemakers Summit, according to the entertainment news outlet 'Deadline'. The actress emphasised that it can be used in a negative manner, so it's important to ensure its rightful usage. "We have to be incredibly cautious and aware of it because there are people who will use it for evil and not good. I do feel that there's a place for it," she said. The debates around the usage of AI in the film industry have been ongoing over the last few years, with some celebrities expressing their disappointment over its use, while others speaking on its usefulness. Celebrities such as Scarlett Johansson, Ben Stiller, Mark Ruffalo and Cate Blanchett have even signed campaigns like 'Stealing Isn't Innovation' to combat unauthorised AI training on human work. 'Practical Magic 2' is directed by Susanne Bier and also features Nicole Kidman. It is a sequel to the 1998 romantic fantasy film 'Practical Magic'. The



Sandra Bullock thinks Hollywood should be more open to using AI in a 'really constructive and creative' manner

trailer for the sequel recently debuted at CinemaCon in Los Angeles. It was held between April 13 and April 16. The film will be released in theatres on September 18. The original film followed the story of two witch sisters raised by their quirky aunts in a small town. Together, they confront narrow-minded prejudice and a curse that jeopardises their chances of finding true love. It also starred Alexandra Artrip, Evan, Rachel Wood and Stockard Channing. PTI

PULKIT SAMRAT ON PLAYING A BOXER IN 'GLORY'

'IT'S ONCE IN a lifetime opportunity'

The role has also helped the actor move beyond his boy-next-door image

MUMBAI: Pulkit Samrat feels fortunate to play a boxer in the upcoming series 'Glory', a role that has also helped him move beyond his boy-next-door image. The 'Netflix' boxing drama, which also stars Divyenndu and Suvinder Vicky, is written, created and directed by Karan Anshuman and Karmanya Ahuja. "To be getting an opportunity to represent a sport like boxing through cinema, I think it's once in a lifetime opportunity and I'm very grateful and feel blessed," Samrat, best known for his work in 'Fukrey' franchise and films like 'Bittoo Boss', 'Jai Ho' and 'Taishi', said at the show's trailer launch event. At its core, 'Glory' brings to the fore a fractured family forced back together. Raghubir Singh (Vicky), a formidable boxing coach driven by an obsession with Olympic glory, struggles to hold together a legacy that is slowly unravelling under the weight of strained relationships. His sons Dev (Divyenndu) and Ravi (Samrat) return to



Shaktigarh to uncover the truth behind the brutal assault on their sister Gudiya (Jannat Zubair) and the mysterious death of a rising Olympic boxing star, Nihal Singh, according to the official synopsis. "It is the first sports show. We haven't done much sport before. A lot of hard work and blood and sweat have generally gone into it," Samrat said. At the launch event, a live boxing face-off was held between Samrat and professional boxer Neeraj Goyat. The actor said that it was a 'different' kind of experience to step into the ring with a real-life boxer. "Neeraj Bhai, thank you so much for being the

sport. Thank you for considering me enough to stand opposite you in the boxing ring for a fight for three rounds. That was really respectful." Asked about going shirtless in 'Glory' just like how Salman Khan does in his films, the actor said he feels humbled by the comparisons. "Sultan" is the OG inspiration for this entire country," Samrat said, referring to Salman's 2016 blockbuster. "It can never be a competition. I really wish I could look like him when I'm 60 as well. So, I'm very happy with that comparison," he added. 'Glory', produced by Mohit Shah and Anshuman under the 'Atomic Films' banner, will premiere on its platform on May 1. The cast also includes Ashutosh Rana, Sikan-dar Kher, Kunal Thakur, Sayani Gupta, Yashpal Sharma and Kashmira Pardeshi. PTI



The 'Netflix' boxing drama also stars Divyenndu and Suvinder Vicky